Study conducted for:

Lake County IN Economic Alliance

LCEA

Study funded by:

NIPSCO®

FINDINGS REPORT

SSI PHASE II:

PRELIMINARY DUE DILIGENCE

STRATEGIC SITES INVENTORY (SSI) PROGRAM

December 16, 2024

Site ID: 18089-005

Lake County, IN

Study conducted by:

LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

Findings Report

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Lowell I-65 Industrial Park

Lake County, Indiana

Site ID: 18089-005

SSI QUALIFIED SITE

Size and Location

Site: 1,019.3 acres
Buildable Area: 523.1 acres
18882 Mississippi St
Hebron, IN 46341

Lat. 41.2664 Long. -87.3058

Current Ownership

Moon Island LLC
Postma Farms Inc.
Reichert, Kevin L
Cope, Alice (Living Trust)

Highest and Best Use

Light Industrial
Manufacturing

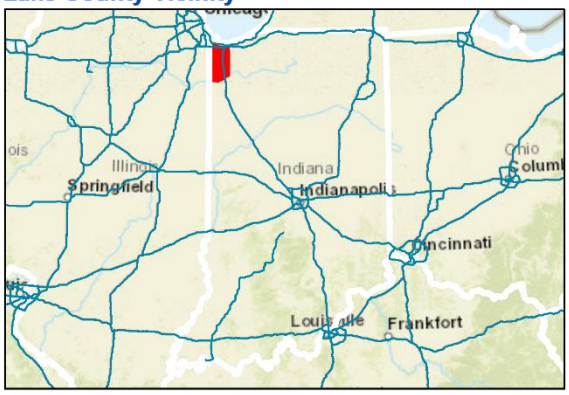
Site GPA

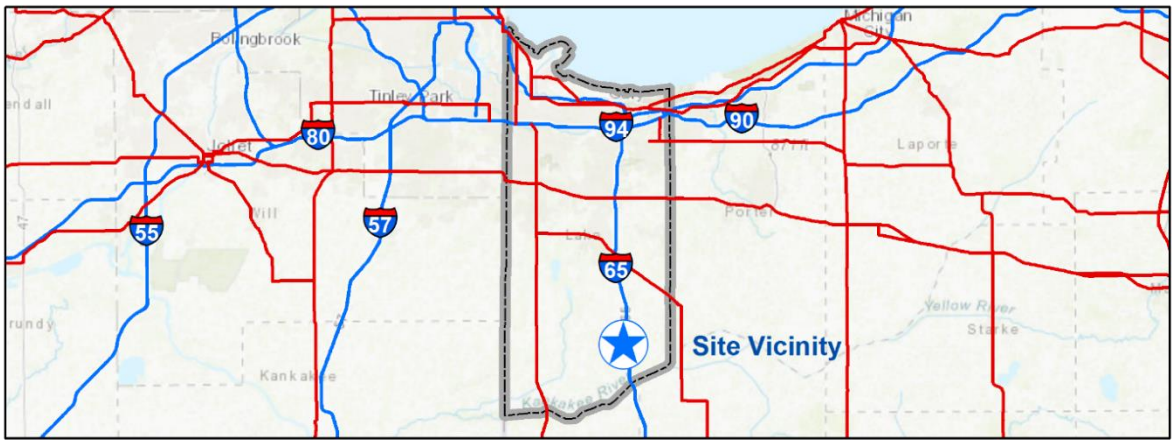
3.6

Legend

- Site Location
- Rail
- Limited Access
- Major Highway
- State Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- County Boundary
- County Boundary

Lake County Vicinity



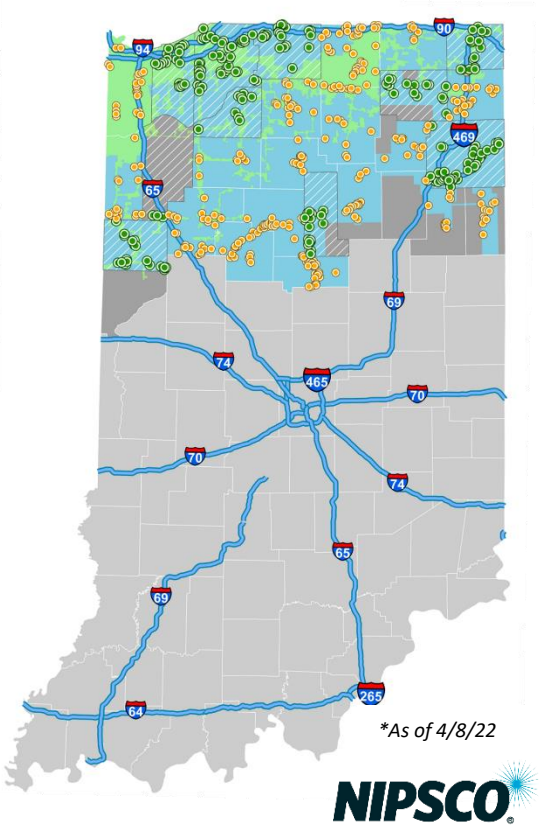


Introduction

This report presents the findings of the Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence assessment of Site ID 18089-005 (referred to as the "Lowell I-65 Industrial Park"), a 1,019.3-acre greenfield property in Eagle Creek Township, Indiana, which is located in Lake County just east of the town of Lowell. The Lowell I-65 Industrial Park was nominated for advancement to SSI Phase II by Lake County officials and the Northern Indiana Public Service Company (NIPSCO). NIPSCO is the largest natural gas distribution company and one of the largest electric distribution companies in the state of Indiana, serving more than 821,000 natural gas customers and 468,000 electric customers across 30 counties. *The subject site satisfies baseline quality criteria, aligns with Lake County industry targets, and is deemed competitive to attract high-value business investments in support of sustainable community job growth and economic prosperity.* Report site maps are included as **Appendix A**.

SSI QUALIFIED SITE

The SSI Program is an advance site selection initiative designed to develop an inventory of strategic real estate assets to attract quality job-creating business investments. In 2019, the Indiana Economic Development Corporation (IEDC) initiated the Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Program in the State of Indiana with *SSI Phase I: Site Discovery* for all 92 counties with a goal to increase economic development competitiveness at the community level by identifying new, top quality raw land sites ideally suited for industrial and commercial projects. Lake County was included in the initial IEDC-funded project and benefitted from the identification of two potential high-value sites for mega site and heavy industrial land uses. A subsequent investment by IEDC in 2020 included expanded SSI Phase I site searches to identify light industrial and agribusiness sites, increasing Lake County's total of quality SSI-identified sites to twenty-five. Following this, one SSI Solar site, three Technology Megasites, and three Hyperscale Datacenter sites have been added to Lake County's inventory of potential high-value industrial sites, thanks to additional IEDC-funded SSI Phase I site searches. A total of 307 sites have been identified within NIPSCO's electric service territory, while 658 have been identified within its natural gas service territory.



Site ID 18089-005 was identified from the expanded 2020 IEDC-funded SSI Phase I project for light industrial and agribusiness land uses, and the site boundary was later adjusted as proposed by Lake County officials. The subject site exhibits necessary competitive characteristics for SSI Phase II: Preliminary

Due Diligence nomination. Details about the SSI Program phases are provided in **Appendix B**.

Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) has developed a systematic and effective methodology for screening potential sites for practical development as part of the SSI Phase II process. LL+D's site screening methodology is informed by fifteen-plus years of industrial and commercial site selection experience and economic development consulting in conjunction with demonstrated geospatial technology-based analysis and mapping expertise. LL+D staff and consulting partners include environmental science, civil and geotechnical engineering, landscape architecture, geospatial technologies, and economic devolvement experts who combine disciplines to identify and evaluate sites for industrial and commercial project uses.

The purpose of the SSI Phase II study is to provide a quantitative understanding of the subject site's advantages and challenges in conjunction with a rough order-of-magnitude (ROM) cost estimate to improve site functional use and mitigate development challenges. The SSI Phase II study is a desktop-based preliminary engineering and environmental due diligence exercise performed by discipline-specific experts with experience in industrial and commercial site selection and property development. Study of the subject site's physical and surrounding characteristics, assets, and impediments for development are reviewed in sufficient detail to formulate a defendable opinion on the competitive strength of the property for an economic development use.

The SSI Phase II study is intended to expose any potential "fatal flaws" that indicate significant development incumbrances or grossly compromise site competitiveness. The desktop review relies on an array of engineering, environmental, ecological, and cultural GIS data in conjunction with aerial imagery and available public records to assess current site development advantages and challenges. The SSI Phase II assessment concludes with the formulation of ROM cost estimates for improving site functional use and mitigating any potential development challenges.

LL+D's team of site selection and economic development experts provided an in-depth study of the subject site through an objective measure of physical features and surrounding characteristics and conditions across engineering, environmental, ecological, and cultural concerns. Overall site competitiveness for an economic development land use is made within the context of location requirements for permitting, construction, and operations relevant to the intended site project land use.

The SSI Phase II findings are expressed along three principal site assessment parameters:

Condition of the site's physical characteristics including assessment of engineering and environmental development advantages and challenges.

Connection to transportation assets, utility infrastructure, and major market areas.

Community support including available workforce, cultural feature impacts, and business climate for economic development.

A description of the subject site and summary of SSI Phase II findings is provided below.

Site Description

The Lowell I-65 Industrial Park is an undeveloped (greenfield) property approximately 1,019.3 acres in total size located along Interstate 65 (I-65) in Eagle Creek Township, in between the Town of Lowell and the Town of Hebron, Indiana. The subject site is comprised of twelve tax parcels, or tracts, independently owned by four landowners of record. **Appendix C** provides a summary of site parcel ownership information.

Site ID 18089-005 south view from Mississippi St.

The current site condition is characterized by mostly farmed agricultural land. A pond exists on the northeastern corner of the site. The property has historically been used for agriculture. There are no structures currently observed onsite. Land use surrounding the site is primarily agricultural, with sparse residential properties nearby and a light amount of commercial activity to the north. A quarry operation is also located east of the site across I-65. The cultural setting is rural. *A contiguous "buildable area" was defined within the confines of the subject site boundary intended to be most advantageous for construction. The Lowell I-65 Industrial Park buildable area is approximately 523.1 acres and encompasses about half of the total site acreage. Flood Zone AE covers nearly 90% of the total site acreage and largely limits the buildable area. Lower elevated portions of the site to the south and southwest were excluded from the buildable area since they are likely the most prohibitive for site development due to the flood zone conditions.*

Geographic Location

Located in northwest Indiana, Lake County provides a primarily urban setting among the high-commercial activity Indiana Toll Road (I-80/90) and Interstate 94 (I-94), as well as Interstate 65 (I-65), with access to major markets throughout the state and proximity to Chicago, IL. Lake County is the second most populous county in Indiana and contains the cities of Hammond and Gary, which rank eight and eleventh among Indiana cities by population, respectively. *In direct linear measure, the site is situated approximately 28 miles southeast of Chicago, IL; 58 miles southwest of South Bend, IN; 106 miles northwest of Fort Wayne, IN; and 108 miles northwest of Indianapolis, IN.* Projects considering the Lowell I-65 Industrial Park will benefit from locating on the outskirts of an urban community that is strongly embedded in economic growth and prosperity amongst a primary network of connectivity, while avoiding the heavy traffic congestion and higher land costs typical of more highly populated metropolitan areas. Access to surrounding labor markets at competitive wage rates is well within reach of the subject site.

The subject site is located in between the cities of Lowell and Hebron, IN, which have 2023 population estimates of 11,239 and 3,735 people, respectively. The site is within Eagle Creek Township, one of eleven townships in Lake County, IN. Lake County is part of the Northwest Indiana region of the Chicago metropolitan statistical area (MSA), which has a 2023 population of 8,937,000. *More than 859,985 total residential population live within a 45-minute drive of the site. Approximately 59,793 businesses employing 914,984 people are located within a 60-minute travel time*. Construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, & technical services account for 17.7% of businesses employing 21.7% of total workforce within a 60-minute drive time of the site. A site vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Site ID 18089-005 Site Vicinity

Current Ownership

The subject site is comprised of twelve contiguous tax parcels, or tracts, and is reported to have four owners. *According to Lake County officials and the county open data map, the current owners of record are Moon Island LLC; Postma Farms Inc; Kevin L Reichert; and Alice J Cope, Trustee of Cope Living Trust. The subject site is comprised of twelve tracts of approximately 305.5, 272.7, 96.0, 80.3, 74.9, 44.6, 41.1, 35.6, 29.7, 21.3, 12.7, and 5.4 acres according to Esri GIS data.* Lake County economic development officials have confirmed that the 4 landowners are willing to sell, though they are not actively promoting the site for sale. As of the date of this report, no known real estate purchase option agreement is held with any person or organization with the landowner for any portion of the site. *LL+D strongly recommends that Lake County pursue and secure a real estate purchase option agreement with the landowners. This is critically important to reduce uncertainty regarding property availability and price*. A "Site Parcel Configuration" map is included in **Appendix A**.

Findings Summary

The findings from the SSI Phase II study are summarized below. A discussion of key site development considerations is provided within the context of overall site physical **condition**, **connection** to infrastructure, and **community** support. LL+D's site competitiveness assessment across these key site development parameters are presented below.

Condition

Site conditions are defined as the physical characteristics of the subject property including geometric configuration, surface features, engineering, ecological and environmental concerns, and land use compatibility. *Overall, conditions for the Lowell I-65 Industrial Park are somewhat challenged due to the presence of Flood Zone AE across the majority of the site's area. However, with appropriate mitigation techniques, workable conditions can be achieved to bring out the site's highest and best use as an economic development real estate asset*.

Size and Configuration of the subject site is sufficient in both acreage and configuration to support a Light Industrial or Advanced Manufacturing operation. *Total site area is approximately 1,019.4 acres, measuring approximately 4,870 feet across an east-west axis at its widest point and approximately 10,220 feet across a north-south axis*. The site is geometrically regular in configuration with adequate land between site boundaries providing ample acreage for a contiguous buildable area. However, the presence of Flood Zone AE across the majority of the site area presents a challenge to contiguous development and will likely require several flood mitigation techniques including structural modifications, equipment protection, drainage systems, and site planning and design. The northern site boundary is bordered by the new John Deere distribution facility. The western site boundary is bordered by Mississippi Street, the site's primary access road to Indiana State Route 2 (SR-2) and Interstate 65 (I-65). The entirety of the site's eastern boundary is bordered by I-65.

A contiguous buildable area totaling 523.1 acres has been defined to optimize facility construction on the site by positioning an operational footprint to best avoid floodwaters and existing drainage features. The buildable area occupies the central and northern portions of the site and is comprised of eleven tracts. Site access is supported by potential ingress/egress points along Mississippi Street at the site's northwest corner. Mississippi Street runs northward from the site and connects to SR-2 for direct access to I-65.

Hydrography and Flood Risk were evaluated by consulting USGS National Hydrography Dataset (NHD), a geospatial database which identifies stream segments or reaches that make up the nation's surface water drainage system, and FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer (NFHL), a geospatial database that contains current effective flood hazard data. *A review of NHD and NFHL data indicates that the full aerial extent of the site exhibits high flood risk potential within the AE flood zone designation and will likely require mitigation efforts. This opinion is subject to verification through a formal land survey and engineering review.* Flood Zone AE is an area designated as a high-risk flood zone by FEMA because of its proximity to floodplains, rivers, lakes, and other bodies of water. AE flood zone areas have a 1% risk of flooding annually with a 26% risk of flooding over the course of a 30-year mortgage.

Nearly 90% of the site and buildable area are situated within the flood plain. Two significant drainage ditches are found onsite – Bryant Ditch and Singleton Ditch. Bryant Ditch runs north to south from the northwestern to southwestern portions of the site and connects to Singleton Ditch near the site's southern boundary. The Singleton Ditch runs northeast from the junction towards Interstate 65. The northern half of Bryant Ditch is included in the buildable area. Existing ditches may be able to provide passive locations for site buildable area drainage and stormwater retention. It may be possible to relocate the ditches to

ensure no interference with site buildable area, though this would require engineering review and design and an assessment of permitting burden and cost feasibility.

In order to prepare the site for development, several steps must be taken to mitigate the current flood zone conditions. A combination of flood mitigation strategies will likely be recommended by the Lake County Drainage Board following a formal land survey and engineering review. Some examples of flood mitigation techniques are detention areas, reservoirs, floodwalls, filters and flow control facilities, levees, culvert installations, flood proofing structures, elevating critical equipment, and raising elevation of portions of the site. An example of a potential mitigation strategy would be to create elevated flood protection areas with earthen berms along the Singleton and Bryant ditches. These floodwalls would be constructed at a higher elevation than the Base Flood Elevation (BFE). Flood control storage facilities (reservoirs, detention areas, etc.) could be constructed west of the Bryant Ditch along the site's western boundary and south of the Singleton Ditch along the site's southern boundary. Flood proofing structures and elevating critical equipment could also be done for lower lying areas.

A flood wall typically needs to be built at least one foot higher than the BFE, which is often referred to as "freeboard" - this additional height provides a safety margin against potential flood surges and wave action. *The elevation just north of the Singleton Ditch along the site's potential area of development (PAD) ranges from 636 to 638 feet. The base flood elevation (BFE) along the Singleton Ditch averages 645 feet, a difference of 7 feet. With one foot of Freeboard needed, a flood wall of at least 8 feet would need to be constructed north of the Singleton Ditch. The flood wall would need to be approximately 3,500' to run along the entire ditch and PAD boundary. The elevation just east of the Bryant Ditch along the PAD's western boundary slopes upwards to the north and ranges from 637 to 657 feet. The BFE along the southern half of the ditch average 645 feet. The PAD elevation along this same portion of the ditch ranges between 637 and 642 feet. The BFE of the northern half of the Bryant Ditch ranges from 646 to 654 feet, increasing towards the north. The PAD elevation increases along with this, ranging from 643 to 653 feet. The difference in elevation between the BFE and PAD elevation is much less drastic here, ranging from a difference of 0 to 3 feet. A flood wall along the Bryant Ditch would need elevation ranging from 1 to 9 feet above BFE. However, the average elevation needed is about 2 feet of Freeboard across the 1.36-mile ditch. Other mitigation measures could be put into place to reduce the height of the flood wall along the southern portion of the ditch.*

A hydrography and FEMA flood hazard map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Potential Wetlands are interpolated through observation of multiple data inputs including:

1) USGS National Wetlands Inventory (NWI) – developed for non-404 jurisdictional wetland mapping, so must be understood to have limited accuracy
2) LiDAR-derived digital elevation model (DEM) – topography/elevation
3) USGS NHD – hydrography
4) NRCS SSURGO – soils data provides hydric rating
5) Color-infrared imagery (where available) – for visual indication of wet or inundated areas (consulting differing years to ensure wet areas are not the result of a period flood event)

The NWI data is consulted as the principal indicator of potential wetlands, as the mapping methodology utilizes the above-referenced inputs in addition to other data sources in conjunction with qualified scientific review and quality control of interpolated wetlands delineation and taxonomy. The NWI data also provides a delineation of wetland types, which is important in the estimation of permitting burden and potential compensatory mitigation costs. Additional data sources are consulted to ensure congruency of information suggestive of potential wetlands occurrence.

From the US EPA Wetland Regulatory Authority fact sheet, wetlands subject to Clean Water Act Section 404 are defined as "areas that are inundated or saturated by surface or ground water at a frequency and duration sufficient to support, and that under normal circumstances do support, a prevalence of vegetation typically adapted for life in saturated soil conditions. Wetlands generally include swamps, marshes, bogs, and similar areas." There are three primary conditions required for surface areas to be considered wetlands: 1) at least periodically, the land supports predominantly hydrophytes, 2) the substrate is predominantly undrained hydric soil, and 3) the substrate is saturated with water or covered by shallow water at some time during the growing season of each year. As determined by the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, the federal agency responsible for enforcing federal laws protecting wetlands, an area must exhibit all three of the above-referenced conditions to be considered a wetland.

The following GIS-based information was consulted for the desktop wetlands assessment:

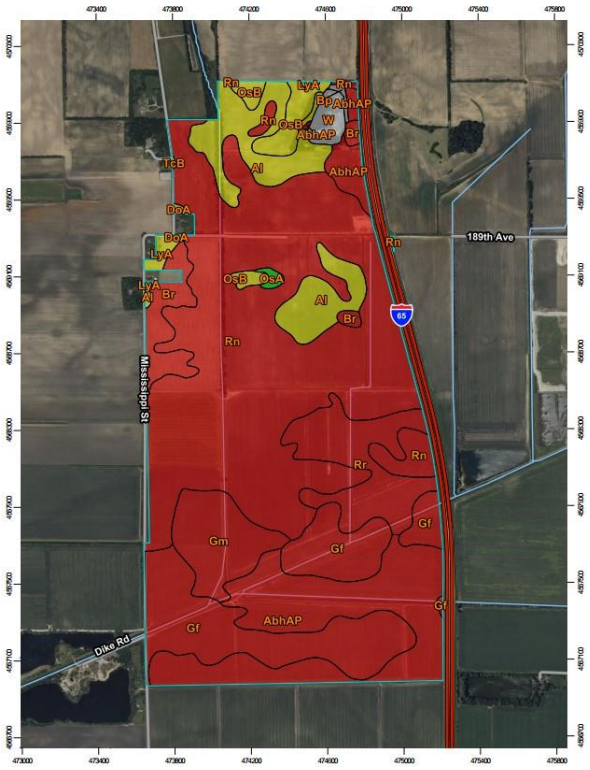
- **Hydrophytic Vegetation**: Recent and historical aerial imagery and NWI data.
- **Wetland Hydrology**: LiDAR-derived DEM, USGS topo maps, and high-resolution aerial imagery.
- **Hydric Soils**: NRCS Web Soil Survey and SSURGO data.

There are approximately 43.61 acres of potential wetlands reported on the subject site. The wetland areas coincide with the onsite ditches and a small pond and adjacent forested area. The larger, open ditches are classified as "riverine" wetlands and consist of 22.2 acres of the total wetlands. Riverine wetlands depend on the flow of water conveyed by natural or artificial channels, including rivers, streams, ditches, and canals. They can form on floodplains, river terraces, and along channel beds, especially where the flows are seasonal or episodic. These wetlands play a critical role in absorbing runoff water and then slowly releasing it before it reaches rivers and streams, thus reducing downstream flooding. *The tree-covered portions of the ditches along the northwestern portion of the site are classified as "Freshwater Forested/Shrub Wetlands". These 10.2 acres of wetlands are included in the buildable area and will likely require mitigation if impacted. A small pond and adjacent forested area on the northeastern portion of the site are classified as "freshwater pond" and "freshwater emergent wetland". These areas are located outside of the buildable area and consist of 11.2 total acres.*

According to the SSURGO Hydrologic Soil Group map, 84.9% of the total site has soils estimated to have hydric components. These soils are primarily found across the central and southern portions of the site and are within the proposed buildable area. These soils present challenges with poor drainage, high moisture content, and potential instability, and may require mitigation measures like drainage systems, imported fill material, and/or site design with elevated foundations or pilings to minimize contact with the unstable hydric soils. While no potential wetlands besides the drainage ditches are reported within the buildable

area, wetland permitting and mitigation may be required on the subject site. NWI potential wetlands map is provided as **Appendix A**.

Soils conditions are assessed to identify potential advantages and/or challenges that could have an impact on site design, construction, and overall use of the site. Soil types are evaluated with respect to drainage and engineering performance for excavations, road construction, and building foundation support. Additionally, hydric soil ratings are used in conjunction with wetlands data to increase confidence in potential wetlands interpretation (reported in previous section).



SSURGO Small Commercial Building Rating: "Very Limited"

According to the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA), Natural Resource Conservation Service (NRCS) Soil Survey Geographic Database (SSURGO) accessed via the NRCS Web Soil Survey, *44.0% (448.6 acres) of the subject site soils are classified as "Rensselaer loam, sandy substratum" with a drainage class of "poorly drained". An additional 48.8% (498 acres) of the site has ratings ranging from "very poorly drained" to "somewhat poorly drained" with soil types including Adrian muck, Alida loam, Brady fine sandy loam, Gilford mucky fine sandy loam, Gilford loam, and Rensselaer mucky loam. The remainder of the site (7.2%, 73.4 acres) are made up of soils with a "well drained" rating; these include: Borrow pits, Door loam, Lydick loam, Oshtemo fine sandy loam, and Tracy loam.* The majority of onsite soils are assigned to SSURGO hydrologic soil groups and have slow infiltration rates with high runoff potential.

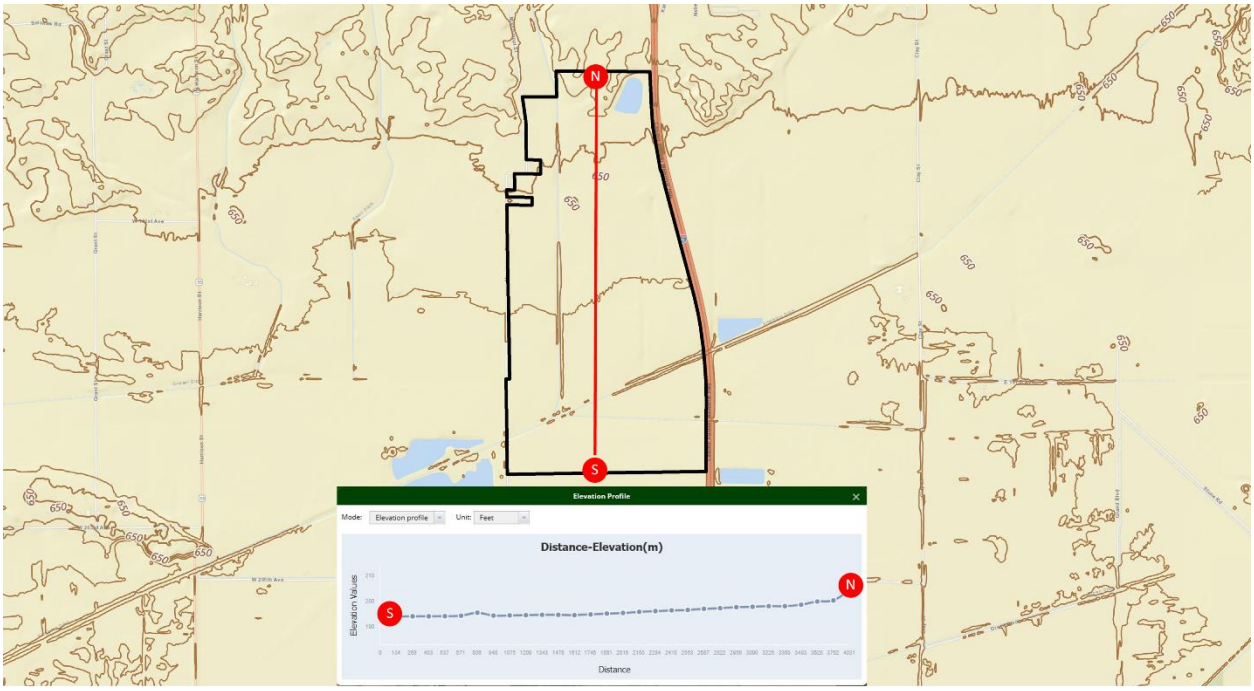
Soil suitability properties for small commercial building construction across 88.0% (897.9 acres) of the subject site are indicated as "Very limited" for shallow (2 feet deep) reinforced concrete footings. "Very limited" indicates that the soil has one or more features that are unfavorable for the specified use. The limitations generally cannot be overcome without major soil reclamation, special design, or expensive installation procedures. Poor performance and high maintenance can be expected. The remainder of the site is listed as "Somewhat limited", indicating that that the soil has features that are moderately favorable for the specified use. These soils coincide with the better draining and higher elevated northern portion of the site.

Substantial foundation requirements may not be supported by the soil conditions and must be determined through on-site geotechnical engineering investigation. The limitations can be overcome or minimized by

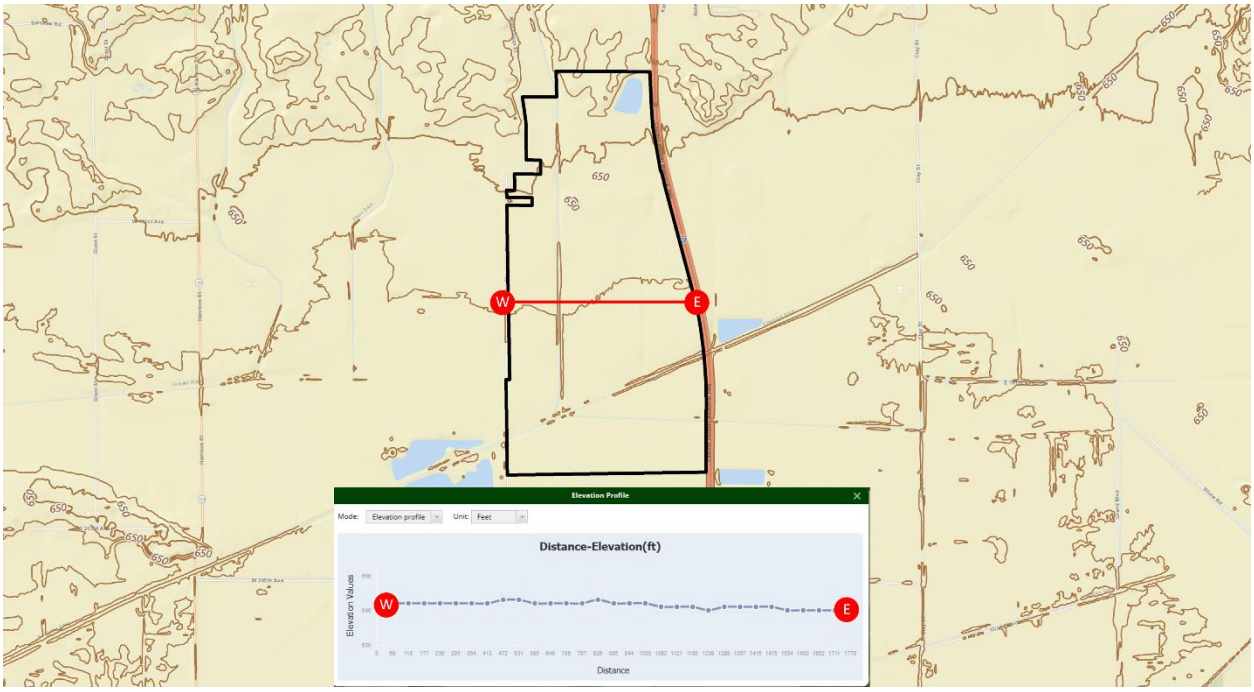
special planning, design, or installation. A SSURGO soils map is provided in **Appendix A**. The USDA, NRCR SSURGO soils reports for drainage class, small commercial buildings, and hydric rating are provided in **Appendix G**.

Elevation/Topography presents minor grading challenges to prepare the site for development. *Based on a review of 5-meter cell size, LiDAR-derived digital elevation models (DEM) for the full site extent, a minimum elevation of 637 feet mean sea level (MSL) and maximum elevation of 674 feet MSL is reported. The 2023-2024 DEM indicates an average buildable area elevation of 643 feet MSL and average slope of 0.4 percent*.

The majority of the site is generally flat and without significant sloping. The site generally slopes downward from north to south with a high elevation to north of 674 feet and a low to the south of 637 feet. There is not much elevation change from east to west across the entirety of the site. The lowest elevation occurs along the southernmost portion of the site, just outside of the buildable area. With the flat topography, there are not likely many cut-fill opportunities for use of onsite fill for grading/leveling. This analysis is subject to an onsite geotechnical engineering investigation to determine suitability of soil properties for construction. Additionally, any areas of naturally occurring sloping topography may provide passive locations for site buildable area drainage and stormwater retention. A LiDAR-derived DEM and 10-ft contour map is provided as **Appendix A**.



18089-005 Elevation Profile North-South (USGS 3DEP Viewer)



18089-005 Elevation Profile West-East (USGS 3DEP Viewer)

Land Cover assessment is useful for identifying site design constraints and/or potential encumbrances that may be encountered during site development such as extensive clearing and grubbing, drainage concerns, etc. The vegetative cover type is used in conjunction with soil types, elevation, and hydrography data for interpretation of environmentally sensitive conditions such as wetlands and potential habitat for Threatened and Endangered (T&E) species and other species of concern (discussed later in this report). Certain land cover features may reveal commercial value of forested areas or be desirable to incorporate into the site design. Features such as densely wooded areas may provide a desirable buffer during construction and/or during facility operations for line of sight and noise control. Another example is integrating wetland areas into site plans, thus providing an element of design aesthetics.

Two primary sources were used to assess land cover characteristics:

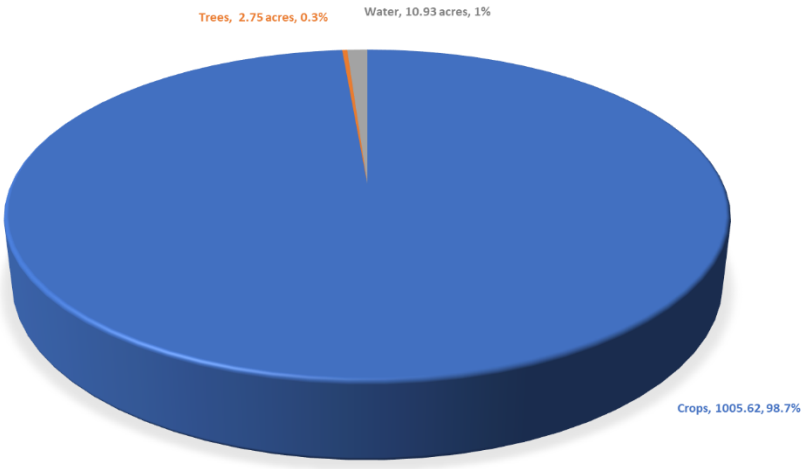
1) *Recent high-resolution color aerial imagery* (ESRI/Google Earth 2022). Recent and past aerial imagery provide useful observational data for assessing current land cover conditions, as well as any notable changes over time. However, aerial imagery alone cannot be used without additional data sources to provide a more specific delineation of land cover type. For example, densely wooded areas are readily observed from aerial imagery, however, determination of forest composition is largely indeterminate without other remotely sensed inputs (i.e., color infrared imagery) or ground-based observation.

2) *The Multi-Resolution Land Characteristics Consortium (MRLC), National Land Cover Database (NLCD)*. The National Land Cover Database (NLCD) provides nationwide data on land cover and land cover change at a

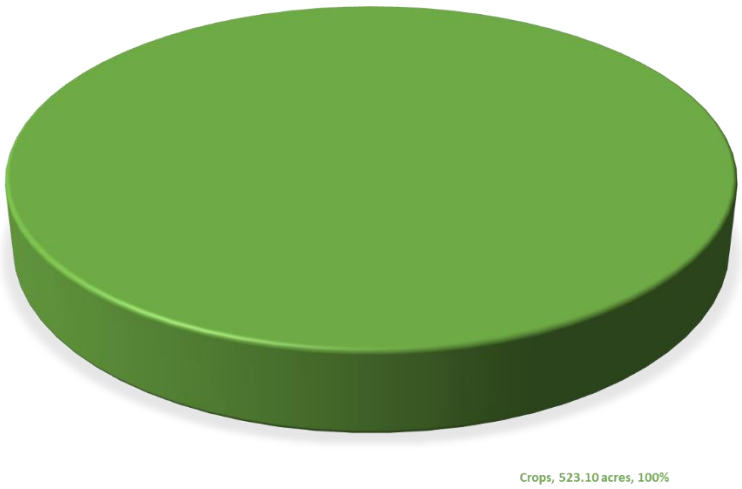
30m resolution with a 16-class legend based on a modified Anderson Level II classification system. NLCD 2019 represents the latest evolution of NLCD land cover products focused on providing innovative land cover and land cover change data for the Nation. NLCD 2019 offers 8 integrated epochs of land cover for years 2001, 2004, 2006, 2008, 2011, 2013, 2016, and 2019. Developed classes in these years are directly derived from percent developed impervious surface and include a descriptor label that identifies the type of each impervious surface pixel. The NLCD Land Cover change index combines information from all years of land cover change and provides a simple and comprehensive way to visualize change from all 8 dates of land cover in a single layer.

Based on a review of the MRLC NLCD dataset, land cover for the site and buildable area consists of the following classified areas (acres, percent cover):

Land Cover – Site (acres, %)



Land Cover – Buildable Area (acres, %)



The site buildable area is entirely made up of pastureland and crops. The total site area has a 10.93-acre pond to the northeast and 2.75-acre forested area adjacent to the pond to the west.

A land cover map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Sinkholes are common geological phenomenon occurring throughout the United States. They are only one of many kinds of karst landforms, which include caves, disappearing streams, springs, and underground drainage systems. Karst is a generic term which refers to the characteristic terrain produced by erosional processes associated with the chemical weathering and dissolution of limestone or dolomite.

The Sinkhole Areas and Sinking-Stream Basins Map developed by the Indiana Geological Survey shows the locations of sinkhole areas (SHA) and sinking-stream basins (SSB) in southern Indiana. Some sinkholes may exist outside the delineated areas, and some sinkholes may exist within the areas designated as sinking-stream basins, but such areas are not shown in this map. *The subject site lies entirely outside of the SHA and SSB areas, and thus should not be at risk of sinkholes.* The reliability of reported sinkhole occurrences is unknown. Potential site susceptibility to sinkholes must be determined through more thorough professional geological and geotechnical engineering investigation.

Zoning and Land Use is administered and governed by the Lake County Unified Development Ordinance (UDO) No. 2560. *According to SSI Pre-Project Questionnaire, the site is currently zoned Agricultural/Commercial. The Unincorporated Lake County Zoning Web Map shows the entirety of the site as being zoned A-1 Agricultural. The Lake County Comprehensive Plan shows the site's designated future land use to be Agriculture.* Current Zoning and Future Land Use maps are provided in **Appendix D.**

The apparent current land use of the subject site is derived from the SSI Pre-Project Questionnaire, the Lake County GIS portal, recent aerial imagery, and Google Street View. *Recent aerial imagery shows current land use to be improved agricultural land for the entirety of the site, containing minimal forested areas and lack of commercial structures. Current conditions also show that a pond exists in the site's northeast corner. The aerial imagery-derived land use observations for the site agree with the Lake County UDO's Agricultural designation. It also matches with the NLC Database – Cultivated Crops (98.7%), Ponds (1%), and Deciduous Forest (0.3%) land cover classifications.*

Current land use immediately surrounding the subject site consists of primarily agricultural lands, with some moderate commercial and light residential areas nearby. Tracts adjacent to the site are zoned A-1 Agricultural to the west, east, and south; B-3 General Business to the north; and CDD Conditional Development to the east and southwest. There is also an area nearby to the northwest that contains zoning for B-2, B-3, BP-2, and BP-3 (Business and Planned Business Center). According to recent aerial imagery, construction for an industrial facility has begun directly north of the site.

There is little to no indication of other land uses over the last eighty-five years based on a review of historical aerial imagery dating to 1939 (provided by EDR Radius report). Fourteen epochs from 1939 to 2020 were reviewed to determine the sequential occupancy of the subject site. Since 1939, the entirety of the subject site has been consistently used for agriculture. Historical aerial imagery indicates that

construction of the onsite pond began in 1965 and was completed by 1969. Historical aerial imagery is included in the EDR Radius Report provided as **Appendix H**.

Current site land use is ideal to support future development of the site for Industrial land uses. Surrounding tract land use is compatible with the intended site use immediately around the buildable area. The land use is indicated from recent aerial imagery and the Lake County Zoning Map to be primarily agricultural surrounding the site along with some business use. Adequate buffer to residential areas exists so that they should pose no issue to site development. *Tracts surrounding the subject site, and especially the buildable area, should be considered for rezoning with uses that are compatible with the intended industrial uses of the site. Compatibility with surrounding land use is vital to preserving the competitiveness of the site for an economic development use by preventing encroachment of land uses that would create real or perceived risk to prospective business considering the site for development.*

Relevant excerpts from the Lake County Unified Development Ordinance (UDO) No. 2560 prescribing zoning and land use polices, standards, and statutory requirements for land development are included in **Appendix D**. The UDO full documents should be consulted for detailed requirements pertaining to land use and zoning district designations.

Threatened and Endangered Species are defined under the federal Endangered Species Act (ESA) of 1973. The ESA provides a program for the conservation of threatened and endangered (T&E) plants and animals and the habitats in which they are found. The lead federal agencies for implementing ESA are the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service (USFWS) and the U.S. National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) Fisheries Service. The USFWS maintains a worldwide list of endangered species. Species include birds, insects, fish, reptiles, mammals, crustaceans, flowers, grasses, and trees.

The ESA defines an *endangered species* as "any species which is in danger of extinction throughout all or a significant portion of its range." Endangered species are automatically protected by prohibitions of several types of "take," including harming, harassing, collecting, or killing, under Section 9 of the ESA. There are some limited exceptions to these rules listed in Section 10 of the ESA. The ESA defines a *threatened species* as "any species which is likely to become an endangered species within the foreseeable future throughout all or a significant portion of its range." Threatened species receive protections through separate regulations issued under Section 4(d) of the ESA.

LL+D staff consulted the USFWS Information for Planning and Consultation (IPaC) online tool (https://ipac.ecosphere.fws.gov/) to assess potential project effect on listed species (*a plant or animal that receives federal protections under the Endangered Species Act. Species can be protected as endangered or threatened*) and other USFWS trust resources (*includes migratory birds, species listed as threatened and endangered under the Endangered Species Act, interjurisdictional fishes, marine mammals, wetlands, and lands managed by USFWS, such as national wildlife refuges*). The IPaC tool is a project planning tool that streamlines the USFWS environmental review process.

An IPaC Resource List was generated for the subject site. The Resource List is a report that automatically generates a list of species and other resources such as critical habitat (collectively referred to as trust resources) under USFWS jurisdiction that are known or expected to be on or near the project area

referenced below. The list may also include trust resources that occur outside of the project area, but that could potentially be directly or indirectly affected by activities in the project area. However, determining the likelihood and extent of effects a project may have on trust resources typically requires gathering additional site-specific (e.g., vegetation/species surveys) and project-specific (e.g., magnitude and timing of proposed activities) information.

The IPaC trust resources report lists critical habitats and species of concern known or suspected to be found in habitats within regional ecology. The IPaC trust resources report found that the following species may potentially be affected by activities in this location:

- **Mammals**:
  - Indiana Bat (*Myotis sodalist*) – Endangered
- **Birds:**
  - Whooping Crane (*Grus americana*) – Experimental Population, Non-Essential
- **Clams**:
  - Salamander Mussel (*Simpsonaias ambigua*) – Proposed Endangered
- **Insects:**
  - Monarch Butterfly (*Danaus plexippus*) – Candidate
  - Western Regal Fritillary (*Argynnis idalia occidentalis*) – Proposed Threatened
- **Critical Habitats**:
  - There are no critical habitats at this location.

The IPaC report also identifies the Migratory Birds Resource List that identifies certain birds protected under the Migratory Bird Treaty Act of 1918 and the Bald and Golden Eagle Protection Act of 1940. Birds listed in the report are birds of particular concern either because they occur on the USFWS Birds of Conservation Concern (BCC) list or warrant special attention within the subject site location. The report does not include a list of every bird found within the site location, nor a guarantee that every bird on this list will be found within the site. The migratory bird list is derived from data provided by the Avian Knowledge Network (AKN). The AKN data is based on a growing collection of survey, banding, and citizen science datasets and is queried and altered to return a list of those birds reported as occurring in the 10km grid cell(s) that intersect the specified site study area location and have been identified as warranting special attention because they are a BCC species or an eagle (Eagle Protection Act requirements may apply) in that area.

The IPaC Migratory Birds Resource List (MBRL) provides a "Probability of Presence" summary indicating the best understanding of when birds of concern are most likely to be present in the site area. *While there is no immediate known impact to site development, the MBRL should be further reviewed within the context of environmental permitting requirements by a qualified environmental/ecological consultant, as temporal migratory bird presence may affect the timing of certain construction-related activities on the subject site*. The IPaC trust resources report is provided in **Appendix E**.

Legacy Environmental Concerns consist of historical activities and events both on the subject site and on nearby tracts where harmful contaminants were released into soil, surface water, and groundwater. If not properly remediated under state and federal regulatory requirements by qualified environmental

consultants/contractors, historical contamination liabilities may be inherited through chain of title even if the contamination originated offsite, particularly with migration through groundwater transport. The historical environmental event implication for site development depends on many factors including the type, extent, concentration, complexity, physical setting and surface/subsurface conditions, and time since the event, which may or may not pose a risk to prospective investors on site development.

A cursory review of the subject site and surrounding properties was conducted to identify any potential legacy environmental concerns. Informational resources consulted for this review include:

- EDR Radius Report;
- Recent and historical aerial imagery review;
- US Environmental Protection Agency's (EPA) Enforcement and Compliance History Online (ECHO) database (EDR Radius Report limits ECHO database search to the target property); and
- Information provided through interviews with local political officials, economic development representatives, and landowners (where available)

The EDR Radius Report searches environmental databases for permitted facilities, events, and other potential concerns occurring on the subject site and up to 1.0 mile of the site boundary. EDR use statement: "*A search of available environmental records was conducted by Environmental Data Resources, Inc (EDR). The report was designed to assist parties seeking to meet the search requirements of EPA's Standards and Practices for All Appropriate Inquiries (40 CFR Part 312), the ASTM Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments (E 1527-13), the ASTM Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments for Forestland or Rural Property (E 2247-16), the ASTM Standard Practice for Limited Environmental Due Diligence: Transaction Screen Process (E 1528-14) or custom requirements developed for the evaluation of environmental risk associated with a parcel of real estate*".

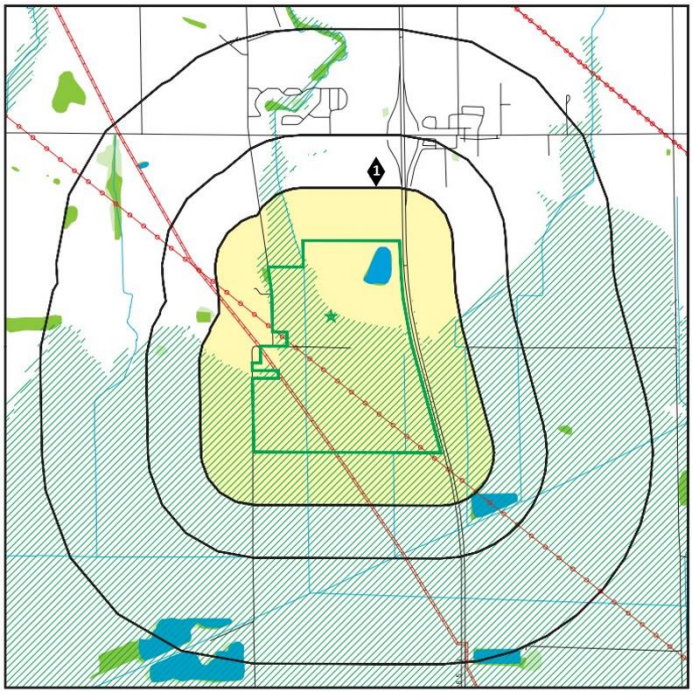
Based on the results of the EDR Radius Report and a cursory review of historical aerial imagery, no apparent environmental legacy concerns were identified on the subject site. Three facilities appearing in multiple databases were identified within 0.1 to 0.5 miles of the subject site in the EDR Mapped Sites Summary:

- ***Underground Storage Tank***
  - *Database description: A national composite of leaking underground storage tanks. This data contains information about, and locations of, leaking underground storage tanks.*
  - *Site Name: HALLMARK CONSTRUCTION*
  - *Distance: 0.32 miles to the N/NE*
  - *Elevation: 676 ft (higher)*
  - *Map ID* **1** *(overview map below)*

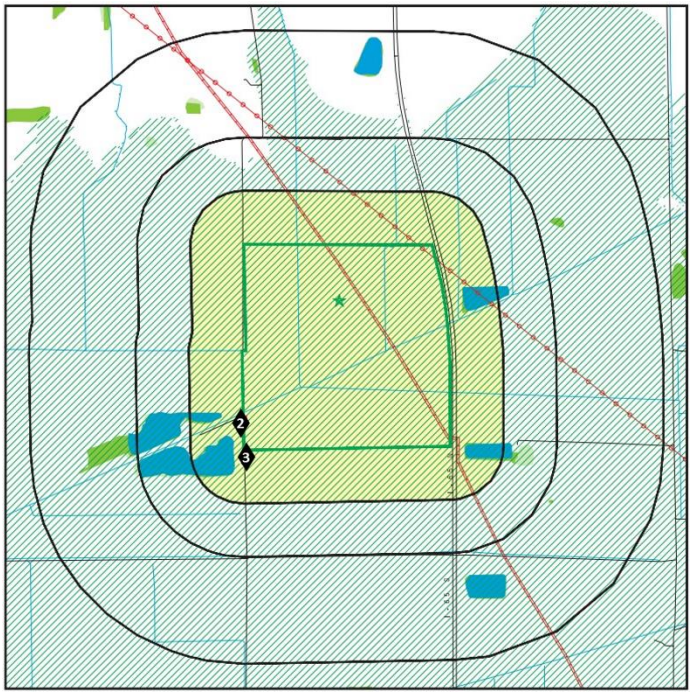
- ***Abandoned Mines***
  - *Database description: An inventory of land and water impacted by past mining (primarily coal mining) that contains information on location, type, and extent of AML impacts, as well as cost associated with the reclamation of those problems.*
  - *Site Name: U.S. AGGREGATES EAGLE CREEK SAND & GRAVEL*

- *Distance: 60 feet to the SW*
- *Elevation: 637 ft (lower)*
- *Map ID 2*

- ***US Mines***
  - *Database description: Contains all mine identification numbers issued for mines active or opened since 1971. The data also includes violation information.*
  - *Site Name: HERITAGE AGGREGATES*
  - *Distance: 316 feet to S/SW*
  - *Elevation: 640 ft (lower)*
  - *Map ID 3*



EDR Radius Report Mapped Sites Overview Map (Top Half)



EDR Radius Report Mapped Sites Overview Map (Bottom Half)

Map ID 1 consists of five underground storage tanks (USTs) operated by Hallmark Constructed LLC. The USTs were installed in 1986 and are designated as either closed or temporarily out of service. Three of the tanks contained gasoline and two contained diesel fuel. There are no records of leaks or groundwater contamination. The facility point is located just north of the site at a higher elevation. Aerial imagery from 2024 shows a footprint of an abandoned facility near the underground storage tanks, likely an old gas station.

Map IDs 2 and 3 are sand and gravel mining pits that were recorded as being abandoned in 2007. The operator name for both records is Heritage Aggregates LLC. The mines received multiple citations for violations between 2002 and 2006 before being abandoned in 2007. The

mines are located just southwest of the site and now are filled with water. Both mines are reported at a lower elevation than the subject site. Potential transport of contaminants to the subject site is not likely and is dependent upon groundwater impacts and transport via groundwater.

While no contamination is reported in the EDR Radius Report, the extent of potential contamination resulting from the cited facilities may not be fully understood without conduction of more extensive environmental site investigations by a qualified consultant.

Full facility information is provided in EDR Radius Report is provided as **Appendix H**.

As the EDR Radius report limits environmental database searches to the subject site and within 1.0 mile of the subject site, the EPA ECHO database was consulted for potential significant environmental concerns within 2.0 miles of the site including active permitted facilities operating under the EPA Clean Water Act, Title V of the Clean Air Act, or the Resource Conservation and Recovery Act (RCRA) for control of solid waste. In limited instances, new air permit applications can be subject to more stringent requirements based on nearby existing permitted facilities' total air emission pollutant volumes and concentrations.

Based on the expanded ECHO search, no environmental legacy concerns were identified on the subject site. No significant environmental concerns within 2.0 miles of the site were found besides those already discussed in the EDR Radius Report. The ECHO site search results are provided in **Appendix H**.

As with any desktop research exercise, actual potential environmental concerns may not be fully recognized or understood without conducting an on-site field investigation. The industry standard for real estate environmental review is the Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA). Governed by the ASTM E1527: *Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments: Phase I Environmental Site Assessment Process.* The Phase I ESA is designed to investigate property prior to ownership transfer or improvements for use to identify and document any existing or potential contamination that must be addressed or give cause for liability. The Phase I ESA methodology includes more detailed research and review of environmental databases, historical aerial imagery, title research, and on-site field observations of the subject site and immediately surrounding properties.

Connection

Site connectivity includes access to key transportation assets and utility infrastructure sufficient for the use intensity of the subject site. Access to available workforce is also measured within the context of the intended economic development project use (e.g., heavy industrial, light industrial, commercial/freight logistics, etc.). *The Lowell I-65 Industrial Park is well connected to transportation and utility assets with close proximity to local utilities access (potable water, sewer, electric, natural gas, and telco/broadband). In conjunction with strong community support and adequate workforce availability, the site is well positioned for competitive response to light industrial/manufacturing project opportunities*.

Transportation Assets are in place to serve the logistical needs of commercial/industrial business operations in the area. *Substantial transportation connections to the site include Interstate 65 frontage and access within 1.5 mile.*

Access to the site is currently available via Mississippi St., a two-lane road that runs along the site's western boundary. Appropriate road grading to Mississippi St. is likely needed to ensure proper drainage, a smooth driving surface, and the ability to handle heavy vehicle traffic to accommodate large loads and frequent use. County officials have stated in the SSI PII pre-project questionnaire that improvements to site access along Mississippi St. shall occur in the near term. An additional site access point may be possible via a road extension from the facility under construction just north of the site. This should be locally confirmed and further discussed with county officials. From the site point of ingress/egress, truck traffic must travel 0.6 miles to Indiana State Road 2 (SR-2), a principal arterial highway, then travel approximately 0.6 miles east to the Interstate 65 (I-65) onramp. Proximity to I-65 is considered a site advantage. A site access map is included in **Appendix A**.

Truck Routes accessible by the site include I-65 for direct north-south travel. Other options for north-south travel are US Highway 231 and US Highway 41, located on either side of the site approximately 6.6 and 8.6 miles from the site point of ingress/egress, respectively. Routes for east-west travel include US Highway 30 and I-94, located approximately 14.1 and 21.0 miles north of the site via I-65, respectively. I-94 can be taken to reach Chicago and multiple truck routes including I-80/90, I-294, I-290, I-57, I-55, I-88, and various US highways. I-65 can be taken to get to Indianapolis and other truck routes including I-465, I-74, I-70, I-69, and multiple US highways. The site's proximity to several truck routes and close interstate access are considered key strengths. A transportation vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Railroads do not currently extend to the subject site and are not required for the intended light industrial/manufacturing project uses of the site. The nearest railroad is a CSXT main line approximately 4.5 miles in direct linear measure west of the site. It is not practically or economically feasible to construct a rail spur into the site. A transportation vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Airport access is beneficial for both corporate executives and other business-related representatives to travel to a facility during construction and when operational. Cargo airport access provides an opportunity for transportation of process input materials and product distribution.

Gary/Chicago International Airport (GYY) is located within 29.8 miles (~33-minute drive time) of the subject site. The airport has an 8,859-ft runway, which is the 2nd longest in the region and can handle planes up to and including a 777, one of the largest planes in the world. It is a full-service airport with commercial charter, corporate and cargo flights that support the general aviation needs of Porter County.

Porter County Regional Airport (VPZ) is a public-use airport located within 26.9 miles (~33-minute drive time). VPZ features two runways: one measuring approximately 7,002 by 150 feet and another with a length of about 3,449 by 150 feet, both constructed with asphalt or concrete. VPZ primarily caters to general aviation and corporate traffic, with limited commercial flights. As such, the airport's cargo rates are relatively low, and enplanement rates are primarily based on private and corporate flights.

Chicago Midway International Airport (MDW) is located 55.3 miles northwest of the site (~1 hour and 2-minute drive). Midway is a major commercial airport, one of the busiest airports in the nation, and the second-busiest airport both in the Chicago metropolitan area and the state of Illinois, serving 7,669,456 passengers in 2021. The Chicago Midway International Airport covers just over one square mile and has five runways.

Purdue University Airport (LAF) is 68.0 miles southeast of the site (~1 hour and 5-minute drive). LAF is a regional general aviation facility operating two runways at lengths of 6,600 and 4,220 feet and offers commercial charter, corporate, and cargo flights.

Indianapolis International Airport (IND) is approximately 132.0 miles south (~1 hour and 50-minute drive) of the subject site. IND is home to the second largest FedEx Express hub in the world and was ranked as the sixth busiest U.S. airport in terms of air cargo throughput in 2020.

Seaport access is not required for the intended light industrial/manufacturing project uses of the site. However, the nearest seaport is Burns Harbor located within approximately 35 miles (~38-minute drive) north of the site. Burns Harbor is a port focused on steel, agriculture, and manufacturing located on Lake Michigan in the heart of the steel industry.

Utility Infrastructure is optimal for the subject site. Apple Valley Utilities, Inc. (Astbury Water Technology, Inc.) provides water service and sewer lines, NIPSCO provides natural gas and electric service, and internet, broadband, and copper lines are available for telecommunication needs through AT&T. Water and sewer service must be extended southward to the site from an existing main line; the extension shall run along Mississippi Street across SR-2. Significant natural gas and electric infrastructure is available to the site. Copper/T1 broadband is located within 1,000 feet of the site. Site utility information obtained from the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" is provided as **Appendix J**. An energy infrastructure and utility access point map is provided as **Appendix A**. Additional water and sewer utility information can be obtained from the AVU-provided maps, current service descriptions, and phased improvement plans, provided as **Appendix F**

Potable Water is provided by Apple Valley Utilities, Inc. (AVU), which also controls Astbury Water Technology, Inc. AVU's West Service Area (WSA) would provide water to the site. The existing water supply is located north of SR-2 and west of Mississippi St.—the current distribution system would need to be extended south of SR-2. Current capacity for AVU's WSA consists of Well House #1 with two wells each rated for 81.9 GPM or 117,936 GPD total capacity, and Well House #2 with three wells: two rated for 85 GPM and one rated for 175 GPM, or 374,400 GPD total capacity. AVU's water system is currently under development, with Phase I improvements having an

estimated completion date of July 2025. AVU's WSA Phase I improvement plans to Well House #1 include a new water treatment plant, additional well, and expansion to the intersection of SR-2 and Mississippi St. Additional Phase II plans for improving the current water system are also in place. Current and proposed water service flow/capacities should be verified on a project-by-project basis with local water utility officials. Additional utility information can be obtained from the AVU-provided maps, current service descriptions, and phased improvement plans, provided as **Appendix F**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Sewer/Wastewater is provided by Apple Valley Utilities, Inc. (AVU), which also controls Astbury Water Technology, Inc. The existing wastewater treatment plant (WWTP) is located along SR-2 and is rated for 185,000 GPD, with approximately 85,000 GPD in excess capacity. The WWTP expansion is planned in two phases depending on demand: Phase I Expansion from 185,000 to 500,000 GPD (18–24-month lead time), and Phase II Expansion from 500,000 GPD up to 3.0 million gallons per-day (MGD). AVU has a Certificate of Territorial Authority (CTA) of 6,000 acres for their wastewater utility territory. Current and proposed capacities should be verified on a project-by-project basis with local sanitary sewage utility officials. Additional utility information can be obtained from the AVU-provided maps, current service descriptions, and phased improvement plans, provided as **Appendix F**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Natural Gas is provided by NIPSCO via 30-inch and 4-inch natural gas mains. Significant natural gas infrastructure and capacity currently exists near the site. Gas line pressure range (psi) and estimated gas distribution capacity varies depending on project requirements. Projects will be evaluated independently by NIPSCO engineers to determine what, if any, upgrades and extensions will be required to serve the new load. Information provided by Lake County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Electric power is provided by NIPSCO with significant electric infrastructure currently in place near the site. A 12.5kV electric line runs along E 181st avenue, a 7.5kV line runs along Mississippi Street, and a 345kV electric transmission line is within 2 miles of the site. The closest electric substation is located within approximately 16,000 feet. Electric transmission capacity and service type shall be evaluated by NIPSCO on a project-by-project basis to determine the best way to serve the site. NIPSCO engineers will determine what, if any, upgrades and extensions will be required to serve the new load. Information provided by Lake County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Telco/Broadband distribution is available to the site. Copper/T1 infrastructure is located within 1,000 feet of the site. Estimated broadband capacity is 25 Mbps. Internet is provided by AT&T. Information provided by Lake County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Major Market Areas are accessible within a two-hour drive of the subject site. By vehicular travel, the site is situated 54.1 miles from Chicago to the northwest and 128 miles from Indianapolis to the southeast with 2023 total populations of 2,664,452 and 879,293, respectively. Travel distances to major markets and seaports are provided below. A major market vicinity map is provided as **Appendix A.**

Time and Distance to Major Markets

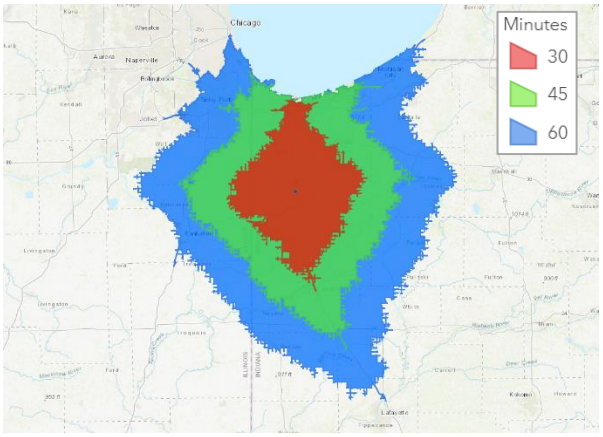
Major Markets	Travel Time	Miles
Chicago, IL	1:04	54.1
Indianapolis, IN	1:55	128
Fort Wayne, IN	2:28	129
Milwaukee, WI	2:33	152
Toledo, OH	3:29	232
Cincinnati, OH	3:33	240
Louisville, KY	3:33	243
Detroit, MI	4:00	269
Columbus, OH	4:25	301
St. Louis, MO	4:26	288
Lexington, KY	4:48	317
Cleveland, OH	5:00	333
Nashville, TN	6:07	417

Time and Distance to Ports

Ports of Indiana	Travel Time	Miles
Burns Harbor	0:38	34.3
Jeffersonville	3:30	240
Mount Vernon	4:45	312

Community

Community aspects conducive to site competitiveness include both measurable and intangible factors that can either strengthen or undermine a site's inherent competitive advantages. While workforce availability and cultural features are commonly accounted for, business and political climate are often neglected, yet serve as an important indicator for both community and governmental desire to welcome new business investment. The Lake County community and political leadership are strong proponents of business growth and new job creation, creating a business climate highly conducive to project investment support through efficient permitting, workforce training, and competitive tax structures. Lake County is committed to supporting long-term industrial and commercial business operations in its communities.



30, 45, 60-minute Drive-time Employment Query

Description of the Economy

Lake County is located in Indiana, a state that boasts a business-friendly environment, solid infrastructure, and substantial creation of manufacturing jobs. The county falls within the Northwest region of Indiana and has a population of 500,598 (US Census Bureau). Crown Point, the county seat, has a population of 34,884 (US Census Bureau). The largest city in the county is Hammond with a 2023 population of 76,193. The county's strong commitment to industry helps to drive local drive economic growth. Lake County is part of and influenced by the Chicago Metropolitan Statistical Area (MSA), an area that spans 19 counties throughout the Midwestern United States and had a 2023 census population of 8,937,000. Further information about population trends can be found in the 2018 Lake County Comprehensive Plan, relevant sections provided as **Appendix L.**

Demographics

Lake County had a 2020 population density of approximately 800 persons per square mile, greater than the state average of 189 ppsm, and is the second most populated county in the State of Indiana. Between 2020 and 2023, the county saw a population growth rate of 0.4%. The population is approximately 58.7% White, 23.3% Black or African American, 1.5% Asian, 0.3% Native American, 8.4% some other race, and 7.8% two or more races. Approximately 20.2% of the population is Hispanic or Latino. The county's median age is 39.3.

Employment and the Economy and Income

Lake County, IN is home to a highly engaged and skilled local workforce with a total resident labor force of approximately 243,424 people. The county annual unemployment rate of 5.0% is higher than the state average annual rate of 3.3%. According to the 2022 US Census Bureau, Health Care and Social Assistance, Manufacturing, and Retail Trade make up the largest industries in the county, employing 15.4%, 15.1% and 11.2% of workers, respectively. The Health Care and Social Assistance sector employs 34,999 people, Manufacturing employs 34,187 people, and Retail Trade employs 25,526 people. In 2022, the highest paying industries in the county for men, by median annual earnings, were Finance/Insurance and Real Estate/Rental/Leasing ($72,401), Public Administration ($69,979), and Manufacturing ($68,957). The industries with the best median earnings for women were Wholesale Trade ($47,746), Manufacturing ($46,539), and Agriculture, Forestry, Fishing/Hunting, and Mining ($45,978). The 2022 median household income is $66,375, which is lower than the median annual income of $75,149 across the United States.

Population/Workforce *within a 60-minute drive time from the site include a total population of more than 2,003,365 and 59,793-plus businesses employing over 914,984 people according to Esri 2024 demographic data. Construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, & technical services account for 17.7% of businesses employing 21.7% of total workforce within the 60-mile radius of the site*. A 30, 45, and 60-minute drive-time query of employment numbers for construction and manufacturing jobs (by NAICS Code) was performed for the subject site. The following employment numbers were reported:

30, 45, 60-minute Drive-time Employment Count*

Business Type by NAICS Codes	Employees		
	30-min	45-min	60-min
Construction	10,432	30,175	55,356
Manufacturing	19,647	61,839	111,126
Professional, Scientific & Tech Services	6,202	21,819	47,979
Totals	**36,281**	**113,833**	**214,461**

**Source: Copyright 2024 Infogroup, Inc. All rights reserved. Esri Total Residential Population forecasts for 2024.*

Lake County target industries include cold storage, manufacturing, healthcare, and transportation. With access to a total workforce of over 986,361, which includes 214,461-plus employed in construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, and technical services sectors, adequate workforce availability should meet medium to large-scale project labor demands of county industry targets. A population and business summary is provided in **Appendix I**.

Cultural Features within three miles of the subject site that may pose community risk or public opposition to industrial development are limited and generally do not affect site permitting, construction, or facility operation. Fire and police protection and emergency medical services are within relatively close proximity of the subject site, however, these facilities do not pose cross-transportation risks for site construction or facility operation. A cultural features map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Schools nearby are primarily concentrated within the surrounding towns of Lowell, Hebron, and De Motte. There are no schools located within three miles of the subject site. The closest school is Lowell High School, located approximately 4.5 miles in direct linear measure from the site's western boundary. Schools should not pose any risk to site development or interfere with primary transportation routes.

Churches within a 3-mile radius of the subject site are limited to Range Line Presbyterian Church, which is located along Indiana State Road 2 approximately 1.5 miles from the site boundary. Several churches are located in the towns of Lowell and Hebron, but these are all sufficiently removed from the site's operational footprint (e.g., buildable area) by 4.5 miles or more. As such, the site poses no significant operational proximity or transportation risks to surrounding churches.

Cemeteries within a 3-mile radius of the subject site include Plum Grove Cemetery and Orchard Grove Cemetery, located approximately 0.7 and 1.7 miles from the site's southwestern corner, respectively. Neither cemetery should pose any risk to site permitting or operation.

Group Care Centers including nursing homes, assisted living centers, special education schools, crisis units, and hospice facilities do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal

site access routes. The closest facility, Two Hearts Homes for Seniors, is located on Clark St. about 4.2 miles from the site.

Other Cultural Centers including libraries, museums and art galleries, movie theaters and performing arts centers, zoos and aquariums, arboreta and botanical gardens, and planetariums do not exist immediately proximate to the site.

Parks and Protected Lands do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. The Grand Kankakee Marsh Co Park is located to the southeast within 2.5 miles, and the Buckley Homestead County Park is located to the west within 3.5 miles. Neither park should pose any risk to site permitting or operation. These areas are sufficiently removed from the operational footprint of the site (e.g., buildable area) and are buffered by agricultural lands. Site ingress/egress road access does not intersect or share park access. A protected lands map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Correctional Facilities including federal, state, and local prisons and detention centers do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. The Lake County Community Correctional facility is located approximately 12.5 miles northwest of the site in direct linear measure.

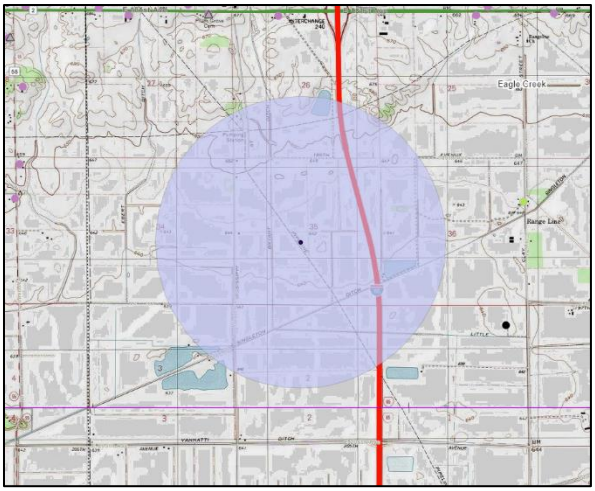
Fire Protection/EMS is provided by the Lowell Volunteer Fire Department, located withing a 10-minute and 6-mile drive via Indiana State Road 2. Another option is the Hebron Fire Department, with the response route within a 13-minute and 8-mile drive via S Washington St to W Church St to US Highway 231 to Indiana State Road 2 to the site. There are also three fire stations located south of the site within a 13- to 16-minute drive via Indiana State Road 55 and Indiana State Road 2 to site access. These are the Shelby Fire Department, Thayer Fire Department, and Lincoln Township Fire Department. Fire and EMS response time and capacity should be locally verified.

Law Enforcement is provided by the Lowell Police Department located within a 10-minute drive and 5.0 miles of the site boundary/buildable area. The response route is via Indiana State Road 2. The Hebron Police Department is another option located a 14-minute drive and 8.7 miles away via US Highway 231 to Indiana State Road 2 to the site. The DeMotte Police Department and Schneider Police Department are located within 22 minutes of the site as well. Law enforcement response time and capacity should be locally verified.

Hospital/Emergency Care is provided by options in the nearby City of Crown Point. The Franciscan Health Crown Point hospital, which is located near the intersection of I-65 and US Highway 231 within 11 minutes and 8.8 miles of the site access point, is a new facility that includes 199 inpatient beds with room to expand to 300, as well as an attached medical office building and expandable diagnostic and treatment centers. UChicago Medicine Crown Point is accessible from the site within 13 minutes and 10.7 miles and features an 8-bed emergency department and small inpatient unit, an outpatient surgery center, and a cancer center. Pinnacle Hospital, located within 19 minutes and 13.3 miles, is a quality acute care facility that features 18 beds and five operating suites. EMS response time and capacity should be locally verified.

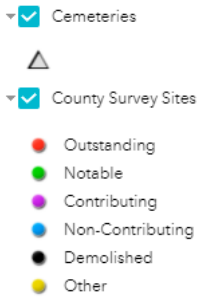
Historical Preservation records include locations of cultural or archaeological significance, some of which are formally designated as state and/or federally protected historical resources under State Historic Preservation Offices (SHPO) and/or National Register of Historic Places registrations. Historical resources, if located on the subject site, may alter, impede, or preclude development if potential for disturbance or encroachment exists. Historical resources located near the subject site may warrant mitigating site planning and design elements such as line-of-site buffering between facilities and a historically significant structure. The Indiana Department of Natural Resources (IDNR) houses the Division of Historic Preservation and Archaeology (DHPA), which promotes the conservation of Indiana's cultural resources. The DHPA facilitates state and federal preservation programs and is the staff of the State Historic Preservation Office. The DHPA's Archaeology Team administers programs for protecting and preserving Indiana's prehistoric and historic archaeological sites, is the central repository of archaeological records and reports, and houses the state's official computerized database of archaeological site information.

Several cultural resource GIS datasets from the IDNR were consulted for potential location of culturally or historically significant resources on or near the subject site. These datasets are collected and contained within the State Historic Architectural and Archaeological Research Database (SHAARD), which allows users to search cultural resource information on known historic and archaeological resources throughout the State of Indiana. SHAARD includes data from the Indiana Historic Sites and Structures Inventory county survey (IHSSI), the Indiana Cemetery and Burial Ground Registry, historic bridges and canals, historic theaters, and properties listed in the National Register of Historic Places and the Indiana Register of Historic Sites and Structures. The data contained in SHAARD was collected from previously conducted cultural resource inventories, National Register nominations, and cultural resource management projects. SHAARD and associated resource maps are ongoing initiatives and are updated daily, so the absence of data does not necessarily indicate the absence of resources. A more formal archaeological survey may be necessary prior to site development.



SHAARD Map Search

A desktop data review was conducted regarding available records for potential cultural resources present on the subject property. *The SHAARD database identified no archaeological sites and no historic structures on the subject site. The Indiana Historic Buildings, Bridges, and Cemeteries (IHBBC) Map identified no cultural resources within a 1-mile radius of the subject site's centroid.* A Historic Resource search map is provided as **Appendix A**.



As with any desktop research exercise, actual potential historic preservation concerns may not be fully recognized or understood without conducting an on-site field investigation. The industry standard for real estate environmental review is

the Phase I Cultural Resources Survey. The primary objective of a Phase I archaeological survey is to identify and record all cultural resources within a project area. Cultural resources can include prehistoric Native American habitation sites, historic farmstead sites, standing structures, or other man-made features such as earthworks, old roadbeds, or cemeteries. The Phase I survey process typically begins with Phase IA Archaeological Reconnaissance to conduct historical research, environmental context review, and field inspection. When an archaeological site is encountered, a full written report must be submitted following guidance provided in the Current Guidebook for Indiana Historic Sites and Structures Inventory—Archaeological Sites and the Indiana Cultural Resources Manual.

Indiana Code 14-21-1 provides protection for archaeological sites and historic burial sites regardless of their location on state or private lands. All archaeological sites with artifacts dating before December 31, 1870 are protected under this act. Human burial sites are afforded protection under IC 14-21-1, IC 14-21-2, IC 23-14 (Indiana General Cemetery Act). The State of Indiana implements specialized reviews that provide protection to historic properties on state-owned or leased land or to historic properties that are listed in the National Register of Historic Places or the Indiana Register of Historic Sites and Structures and that will be altered, demolished, or removed using state funds. These review processes are established in Sections 14, 16, and 18 of Indiana Code 14-21-1. In addition, projects that will disturb the ground within 100 feet of a cemetery or burial ground for the purpose of excavating or covering the ground or erecting, altering, or repairing any structure are reviewed in Sections 26-26.5. In order to increase the confidence in understanding any potential historical preservation concerns for the subject site, it is recommended that a Phase I archaeological survey be conducted by a qualified cultural resource management/archaeological consulting professional and that archaeology state laws listed in Title 14, Article 21 of the Indiana Code are thoroughly understood. Relevant sections of the Indiana Code are provided as **Appendix K.** Information regarding Indiana Archaeology Law, complete with links to the full Indiana Code and Indiana Administrative Code, is also provided as **Appendix K.**

Education and Technical Training Assets are well positioned to serve professional and technical workforce needs of Lake County target industries, while colleges and universities provide valuable recruiting opportunities to local businesses.

The Indiana Department of Workforce Development (DWD) offers a variety of services to statewide job seekers looking to enter the workforce, return to the workforce, or locate education and training opportunities. These include Hoosier Talent Network, INDemand Jobs, Indiana Career Explorer, Indiana Career Connect, Cyberseek Indiana, and Indiana Career Ready. The DWD offers several services including job search help, hiring events, training grants, specialized training and more: https://www.in.gov/dwd/.

Indiana's WorkOne Career Centers are the heart of the workforce development system, providing assistance in understanding jobs in demand today, helping workers determine their interests and abilities, offering access to training opportunities, and providing information needed to succeed in today's

economy. WorkOne's Job Opportunities and Business Services (JOBS) Program assists employers in locating and developing a skilled team by determining eligibility, recruiting employees, formulating WorkKeys job profiles, and providing skills assessments to identify gaps and training needs. WorkOne's WIN Career Readiness is a fundamental workplace skills training system available to Indiana residents, employers and training providers. Both the DWD's Work Opportunity Tax Credit (WOTC) and Federal Bonding Program benefits employers by offering incentives for hiring jobseekers who may traditionally have difficulty finding employment.

Next Level Jobs provides free training for Indiana workers and reimbursements for Indiana employers for training employees in high-demand fields. Next Level Jobs assists job seekers by providing Indiana residents with free training in high-growth job fields and the opportunity for them to earn a high-value certificate in one of Indiana's in-demand job fields, tuition free. Next Level Jobs assists employers with reimbursements for training their employees through the Employer Training Grant, which will reimburse an employer for up to $5,000 per trained employee who is trained, hired, and retained for six months, granting up to $50,000 per employer.

The Center of Workforce Innovations is a non-profit corporation dedicated to addressing workforce development needs. The Center acts on behalf of the Local Workforce Investment Board which serves Northwest Indiana in Jasper, Lake, La Porte, Newton, Porter, Pulaski, and Starke counties, providing education resources and workforce training assistance.

The Purdue Technology Center and Research Park of Northwest Indiana is located within 15 minutes driving distance of the subject site. The park supports emerging and developing technologies operating in several high-tech arenas, including fuel cells, imaging, and wireless solutions, and was designated a Certified Technology Park by the State of Indiana. The center encourages the development of high-growth, high-wage business opportunities and facilitates technology transfer between the corporate and academic sectors.

Ivy Tech Community College is a two-year vocational/technical college with a campus in Crown Point that is a 16-minute drive from the site. Other locations surrounding the site within 35 miles in direct linear measure include the Gary, East Chicago, Valparaiso, and Michigan City campuses. Ivy Tech specializes in developing programs geared towards specific skills needed for existing manufacturers and other industries.

Indiana Wesleyan University is located within an 18-minute driving time of the subject site. It is a private university that had a total undergraduate enrollment of 2,236 in the fall of 2022.

Other Indiana higher education centers within 50 miles of the subject site include Indiana Tech, Indiana University Northwest Campus, two Purdue University campuses (Northwest-Hammond Campus and Northwest-Westville Campus), Valparaiso University, and Marian University's Ancilla College.

The University of Notre Dame du Lac (Notre Dame), a private Catholic research university outside the City of South Bend, is located within a 75-minute drive time of the site. Notre Dame has been recognized as one of the top universities in the United States and has been at the forefront in research and scholarship and had a total undergraduate enrollment of 8,971 in the fall of 2022.

The site is within reach of several colleges and trade schools in the Chicago area as well, which is approximately a 1-hour drive time of the subject property. These include the University of Illinois at Chicago, DeVry University Illinois, DePaul University, University of Chicago, Northwestern University, Loyola University Chicago, and Illinois Institute of Technology.

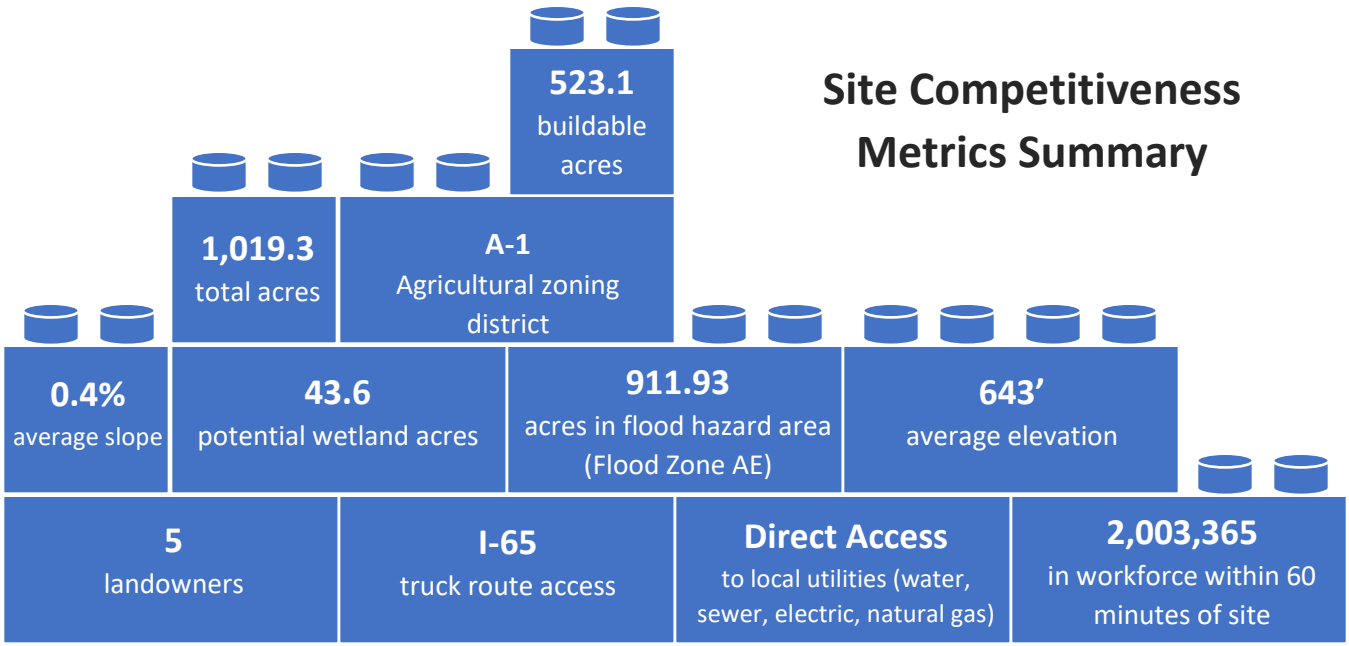
Business Climate is highly favorable for bringing in quality job-creating businesses to the area. Indiana is considered one of the best states in the nation for long-term fiscal stability and low corporate income tax rates, creating a business-forward environment throughout the state. The State of Indiana's target Industries according to the IEDC include advanced manufacturing, aerospace and aviation, ag-bioscience, defense, life sciences, logistics and transportation, and technology. These industries can take advantage of existing transportation assets throughout the state and county to serve an array of unique business logistical needs. The following target industries are listed by the Lake County IN Economic Alliance: cold storage, manufacturing, healthcare, transportation. Lake County has a labor force of 243,424 and an annual unemployment rate of 5.0%. Business development and assistance is provided locally by the Lake County IN Economic Alliance (LCEA) and Lake County Community Economic Development Department (LCCEDD).

Local incentives are offered to support businesses, including project tax abatement to phase in the payment of real and personal property taxes of a business investing in Lake County over a period of up to 10 years. Tax Increment Financing (TIF) is another potential local incentive, which is a method of facilitating development or redevelopment for a business by utilizing future tax revenues to pay for necessary improvements. Another option, the Revolving Loan Fund, has a primary function of providing short-term construction or (5-year Machinery & Equipment) financing to establish or expand eligible industrial or commercial businesses. The maximum loan amount is $2,000,000 and the minimum is $100,000.

In addition, the IEDC provides a variety of programs and initiatives offering business support and expertise to companies that are investing and creating jobs in Indiana. These include the Indiana Regional Cities Initiative, Certified Technology Park program, Broadband Ready Communities program, and Next Level Roads program.

The State of Indiana offers a variety of incentives for all types of businesses, including targeted industries, workforce training, infrastructure and special opportunity incentives. Indiana's business tax structure is competitive—the corporate income tax is decreasing to 4.9%, and the state offers many business tax incentives, corporate tax credits and economic development programs. Statewide incentives include the Community Revitalization Enhancement District (CRED) Tax Credit, Data Center Gross Retail and Use Tax Exemption, Economic Development for a Growing Economy (EDGE) Tax Credit, Industrial Grant Fund (IDGF), Tax Exemption for Patent-derived Income, Skills Enhancement Fund (SEF), Venture Capital Investment Tax Credit program, Hoosier Business Investment (HBI) Tax Credit, Research Expense Credits, Research and Development Sales Tax Exemption, and Redevelopment Tax Credit (RTC).

Political Climate is strong according to interviews with local officials, and the community is largely in favor of commercial/industrial business development to bring long-term economic growth to the area.



Site Competitiveness Report Card

The Site Competitiveness Report Card is an indicator of favorable development conditions across customary competitiveness factors. A relative score for each factor is given as a letter grade, akin to a 4.0 education grade point average (GPA). The GPA is calculated for each competitiveness area: Condition, Connection, and Community with an overall site GPA derived as a relative indicator of site competitiveness for an economic development land use.

Competitiveness Driver		
Condition	Comments	3.3
Engineering		
Elevation/Slope		A
Flood Risk		F
Buildable Configuration		A
Land Cover		A
Environmental/Cultural Resource		
Potential Wetlands		B
Legacy Environmental Liabilities		A
Potential T&E Risk		A
Connectivity		3.8
Transportation		
Interstate		A
Multi-lane Truck Route		B
Class I Rail		N/A
Airport (passenger)		A
Airport (cargo)		B
Seaport/Inland Port		N/A
Utilities		
Potable Water		A
Sewer/Wastewater Treatment		A
Natural Gas		A
Electric		A
Broadband/Fiber		A
Community		3.9
Cultural		
Compatibility with Surrounding Land Use		A
Community Acceptance		A
Economic		
Market Vitality		A
Tax Incentives		A
Labor		
Workforce		A
Wage Competitiveness		A
Political		
Permitting Expediency		B
Business Climate		A

Site GPA

Site Competitiveness Opinion

Overall, the Lowell I-65 Industrial Park in Lake County, Indiana is a competitive greenfield site that is an excellent prospect for light industrial and advanced manufacturing project opportunities.

The site has several competitive features that position it as a strategic real estate asset to support economic development. Firstly, the site has access to all major utilities including electricity, natural gas, wastewater & sewer, potable water, and broadband/fiber. The site also offers a large contiguous PAD of over 500 acres with an average slope of 0.4%. There is a skilled workforce in the area and a population of over 2 million within a 60-minute drivetime. The site's unique strength lies in its combination of available total acreage and infrastructure without any nearby major cultural features or obvious impediments for development. Moreover, its strategic proximity to regional and international airports with freight and commercial services adds to its appeal. The site is in an ideal position for truck access with several different routes available to reach the nearby metropolitan areas of Indianapolis and Chicago including I-65, I-80/90, and I-94. There should be little uncertainty regarding property availability, as Lake County economic development officials have confirmed that the landowners are willing sellers. With Lake County community and political leadership working together as strong proponents of business growth and new job creation, quick permitting expediency should also be expected. Finally, there are nearby hospitals, law enforcement, fire protection, and EMS to provide services to future on-site facilities.

Some challenges for the site also exist, including issues with flood zone, hydric soils, current zoning, lack of real estate purchase option agreement, and potential road improvements needed along Mississippi Street. Currently, just under 90% of the site exhibits high risk flood potential within the AE flood zone designation and will likely require mitigation efforts. In order to prepare the site for development, several steps must be taken to mitigate the current flood zone conditions. A combination of flood mitigation strategies will likely be recommended by the Lake County Drainage Board following a formal land survey and engineering review. Site readiness for development hinges upon this flooding issue, and this will likely need to be the first challenge addressed. Furthermore, the soil suitability properties for small commercial building construction across 88% of the subject site are indicated as “Very Limited” for shallow (2 feet deep) reinforced concrete footings. Substantial foundation requirements may not be supported by site soil conditions and must be determined through on-site geotechnical engineering investigation. This challenge will likely be addressed alongside the flood mitigation discussions.

Another issue that can be handled by county and economic development officials is the site’s current zoning. The Lowell I-65 Industrial Park is zoned Agriculture (A-1) and should be rezoned to Industrial to prevent holdups with permitting and project attraction. Tracts surrounding the subject site, and especially the buildable area, should be considered for rezoning with uses that are compatible with the intended industrial uses of the site. As of the date of this report, no known real estate purchase option agreement is held with any person or organization with the landowner for any portion of the site. LL+D strongly recommends that Lake County pursue and secure a real estate purchase option agreement with the landowners. This is critically important to reduce uncertainty regarding property availability and price.

Considering the comprehensive evaluation presented in the SSI Phase II Report, the Lowell I-65 Industrial Park emerges as a nationally competitive site for attracting impactful light industrial and manufacturing projects to Lake County. Its direct utility access, proximity to interstate access, expansive and suitable buildable area, ample workforce availability, and alignment with county and landowner interests all position it as a prime candidate for development. Flood mitigation strategies and geotechnical engineering investigations should be conducted as soon as possible in order to receive an assessment of permitting burden and cost feasibility. Landowners should be engaged in order to receive a real estate purchase option at a fair market value price.

Subject Site Key Facts

Advantages	Disadvantages
The Lowell I-65 Industrial Park is well connected to transportation and utility assets with close proximity to local utilities access (potable water, sewer, electric, natural gas, and telco/broadband).	As of the date of this report, no known real estate purchase option agreement is held with any person or organization with the landowner for any portion of the site. LL+D strongly recommends that Lake County pursue and secure a real estate purchase option agreement with the landowners. This is critically important to reduce uncertainty regarding property availability and price.
The site is within close reach of interstate access (I-65) via IN SR-2 for truck traffic ingress/egress.	
There is a high workforce population with greater than 2,000,000 people within a 60-minute drive time of the site.	A review of NHD and NFHL data indicates that the full aerial extent of the site exhibits high flood risk potential within the AE flood zone designation and will likely require mitigation efforts. In order to prepare the site for development, several steps must be taken to mitigate the current flood zone conditions. A combination of flood mitigation strategies will likely be recommended by the Lake County Drainage Board following a formal land survey and engineering review.
Access to surrounding labor markets at competitive wage rates is well within reach of the subject site.	
The surrounding land use is ideal to support the development of light industrial and advanced manufacturing project land uses.	According to the SSURGO Hydrologic Soil Group map, 84.9% of the total site has soils estimated to have hydric components.
Lake County community and political leadership are strong proponents of business growth and new job creation creating a business climate highly conductive to project investment.	Soil suitability properties for small commercial building construction across 88.0% (897.9 acres) of the subject site are indicated as "Very limited" for shallow (2 feet deep) reinforced concrete footings. Substantial foundation requirements may not be supported by site soil conditions and must be determined through on-site geotechnical engineering investigation.
The site slopes gently from north to south and has an average slope of 0.4%.	
Based on the results of the EDR Radius Report and a cursory review of historical aerial imagery, no apparent environmental legacy concerns were identified on the subject site.	The site is zoned Agricultural and should be rezoned to Industrial. Tracts surrounding the subject site, and especially the buildable area, should be considered for rezoning with uses that are compatible with the intended industrial uses of the site.

Purpose and Use of Study

Sites originating from Phase I have demonstrated qualitative compliance with engineering. environmental, infrastructure, and cultural location criteria. That said, in order to develop an actionable understanding of true site competitiveness, a more detailed study of the subject site is required. SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence is designed for this purpose.

Purpose

The purpose of the SSI Phase II study is to provide an understanding of the subject site's advantages and challenges to improve site functional use and mitigate development challenges. The SSI Phase II study is a desktop-based preliminary due diligence exercise performed by discipline-specific experts with experience in industrial and commercial property development. Study of the subject site's physical and surrounding characteristics, assets, and impediments for development are reviewed in sufficient detail to formulate a defendable opinion on the competitive value of the property for economic development.

Use

There are three primary intended uses of an SSI Phase II report: (1) site advancement decision support; (2) consideration for investment in site improvements; and (3) site marketing. Each intended use is discussed below.

Site Advancement Decision

The SSI Phase II study is designed to provide decision support for the advancement of sites to market though the landowner engagement process. SSI Phase II findings serve as an indicator for the likelihood the subject site will survive the intensive scrutiny of formal, field-based engineering and environmental due diligence. Detection of severe site deficiencies or encumbrances, often referred to as fatal flaws, during desktop preliminary due diligence can avoid expenditure of significant resources in subjecting sites with little chance of survival to formal due diligence. Short of fatal flaws, SSI Phase II may reveal less than ideal conditions or less severe yet concerning challenges that can marginalize site competitiveness or be detrimental to business attraction, respectively. The most important use of the SSI Phase II study is to ensure confidence in the decision to advance sites to market graduation through subsequent phases for landowner engagement and formal due diligence. *Ultimately, site advancement decisions should be tempered by local industry targets and the host community's real estate needs to support those targets.*

Site Improvement Investment Considerations

The findings of the Phase II study provide concrete data for Economic Development Offices (EDOs) to consider while making investment decisions to improve site marketability. There may be strong business cases for increasing site competitiveness by making incremental investment in infrastructure improvements or mitigation of development challenges. There are many conditions to be considered in investing significant dollars on speculative site improvements including market, economic, fiscal, real estate, and political factors. While the information provided through the SSI Phase II study should not be

exclusively considered for site improvement expenditures, the findings may provide an initial quasi prospectus on site development expenditure and associated return-on-investment (ROI).

Site Marketing

The best greenfield site in America is of no consequence to the host community if industry prospects are unaware of its value and availability. Many EDOs invest in branding and marketing campaigns to showcase their community's differentiating attributes to attract business investment. If prematurely launched, many communities unfortunately become "the dog that caught the car". The well-qualified community successfully attracts the serious interest of a prospective company only to lose the project, and possibly credibility for future projects, because it fails to offer a competitive site.

It is the opinion of LL+D, based on extensive industrial and commercial site selection experience, that the methodology, objectivity, and level of detail and completeness provided in this report are sufficient to support the competitive claims of the subject site for its intended project land use(s). Accordingly, the information contained in this report can and should be used to supplement site marketing materials, specifically for RFI responses and proactive target industry solicitations. However, EDOs should exercise judicious use of SSI Phase II site information for the purposes of site marketing in advance of formal landowner engagement and security of real estate purchase opinion. The real estate purchase option is pursued during SSI Phase III: Landowner Engagement.

Warranty

All Phase II project tasks are intended to serve as an informed guide to determination of site advancement to the formal due diligence phase of inventory development. All information and opinions provided in this report are limited to planning-level engineering and environmental considerations and do not rise to the investigative level of study for site design uses.

All data used in this study originates from public domain sources. All findings derived from the use of public domain data are subject to potential errors and omissions inherent digital data sets which may include spatial and attribute accuracy, completeness, and currency. Data and other information cited in this study has not been verified for quality of accuracy. As such, the confidence in findings provided herein and corresponding opinions are subject to the limitations of the data and other information sources consulted in the conduct of this study.

Ultimate site development potential and fatal flaw analysis cannot be determined without physically visiting the site and conducting formal engineering and environmental due diligence. However, Leotta Location and Design is confident that our site screening methodology is highly effective in eliminating low quality or practically undevelopable sites and presents candidate sites with a high likelihood of confirming results through more formal engineering and environmental due diligence.

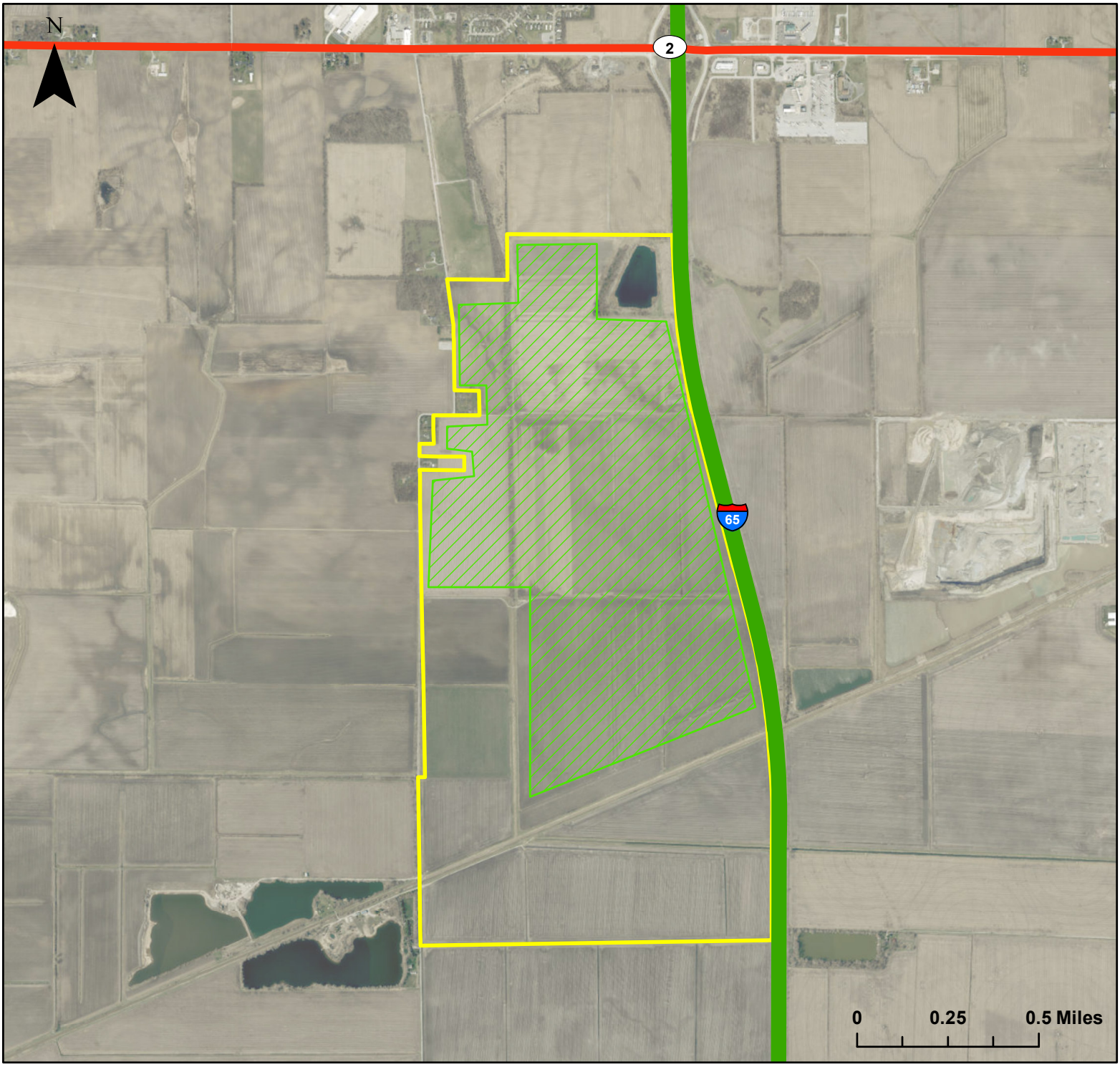
APPENDIX A

SITE MAPS

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Lake County, Indiana

Site ID: 18089-005 (1,019.3 acres)



Legend

- Interstate
- State Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

SITE MAP

Site: 1,019.3 acres

Buildable Area: 523.1 acres

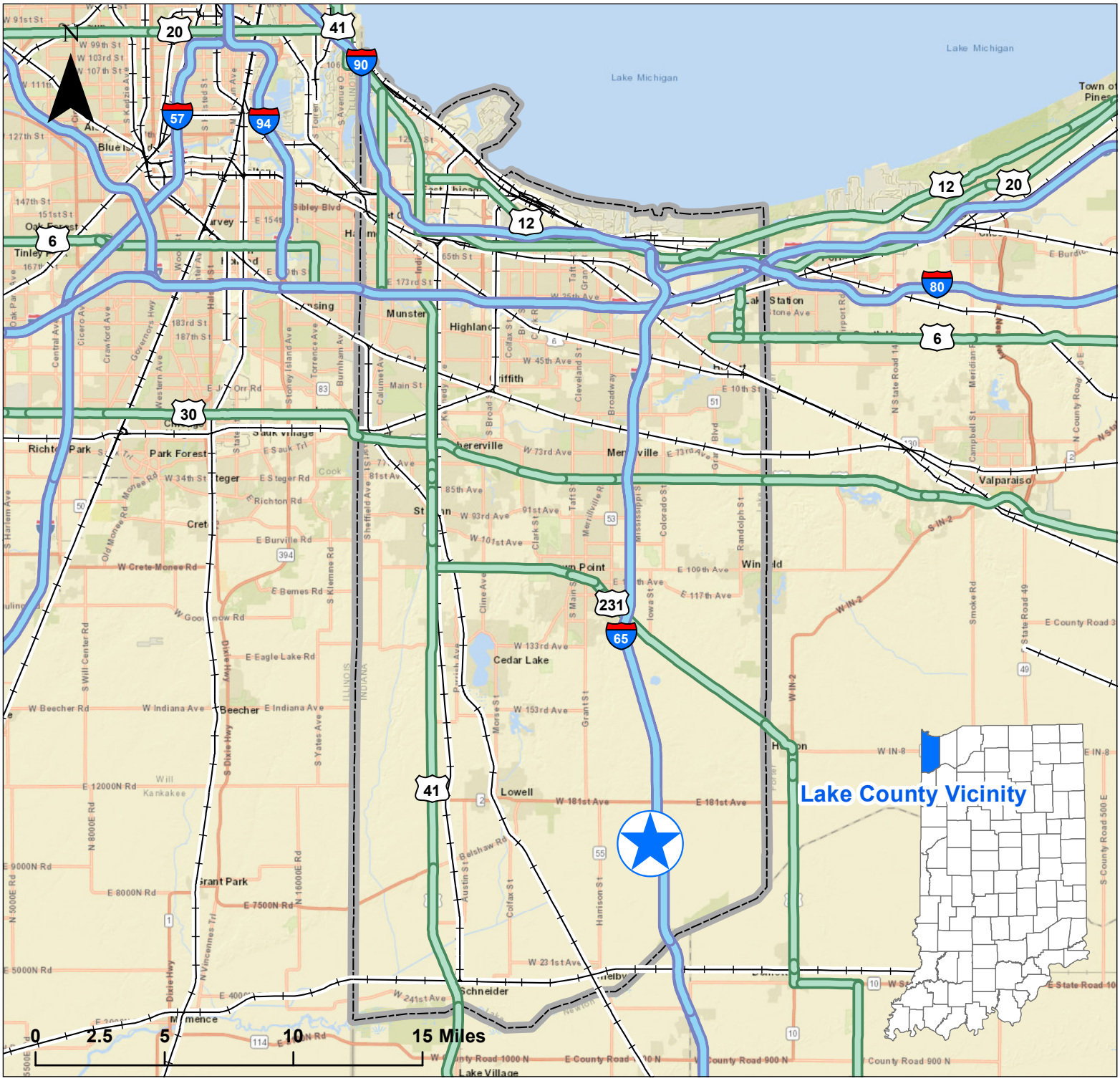
SSI Phase II sponsored by: NIPSCO Energy Efficiency

SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Lake County, Indiana

Site ID: 18089-005 (1,019.3 acres)



Legend

- Site Point
- Interstate
- U.S. Highway
- Class I Railroad
- Lake County

SITE VICINITY

Lake County, Indiana

SSI Phase II sponsored by: NIPSCO Energy Efficiency

SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

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Lake County, Indiana

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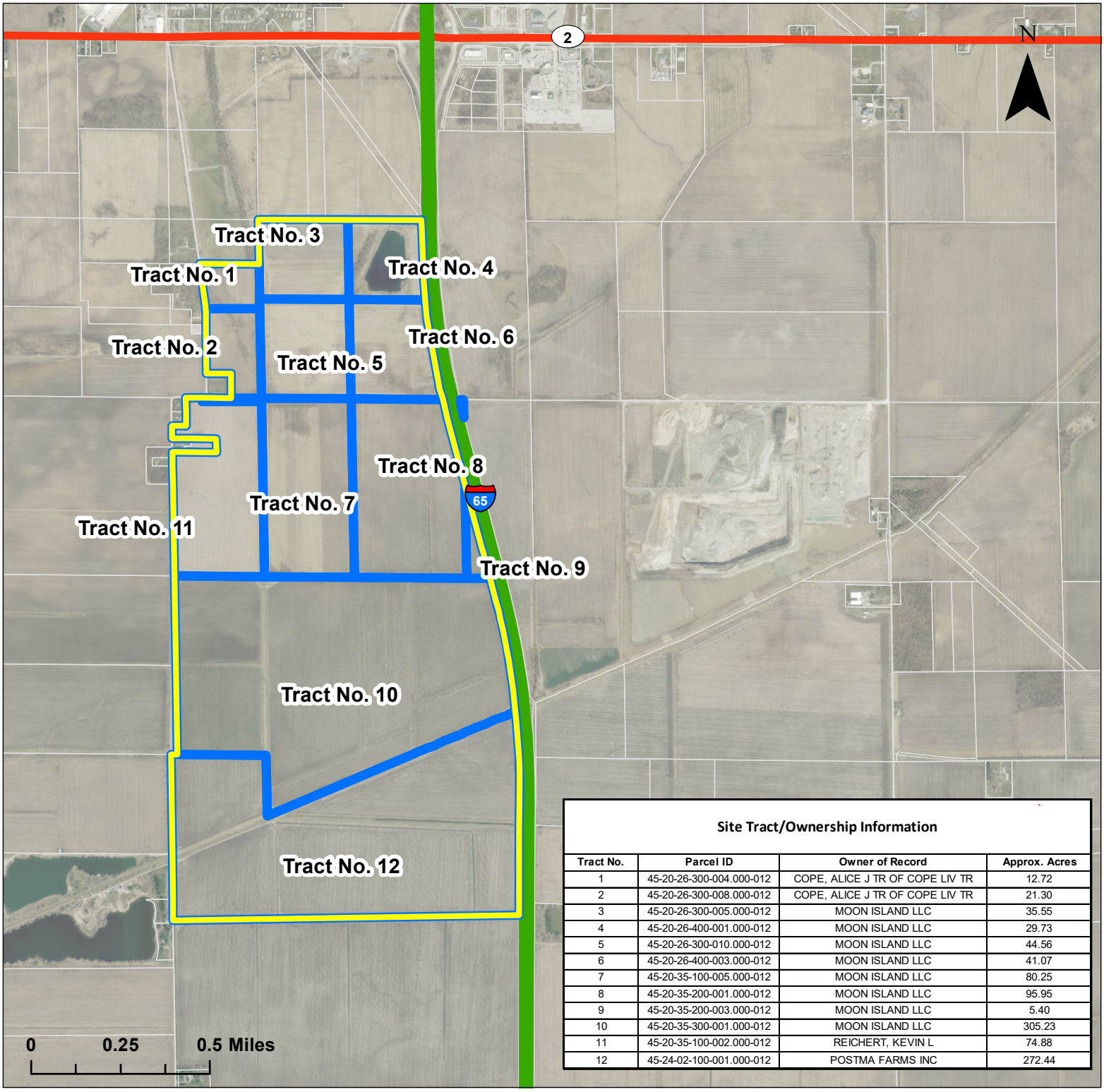


Site Tract/Ownership Information

Tract No.	Parcel ID	Owner of Record	Approx. Acres
1	45-20-26-300-004.000-012	COPE, ALICE J TR OF COPE LIV TR	12.72
2	45-20-26-300-008.000-012	COPE, ALICE J TR OF COPE LIV TR	21.30
3	45-20-26-300-005.000-012	MOON ISLAND LLC	35.55
4	45-20-26-400-001.000-012	MOON ISLAND LLC	29.73
5	45-20-26-300-010.000-012	MOON ISLAND LLC	44.56
6	45-20-26-400-003.000-012	MOON ISLAND LLC	41.07
7	45-20-35-100-005.000-012	MOON ISLAND LLC	80.25
8	45-20-35-200-001.000-012	MOON ISLAND LLC	95.95
9	45-20-35-200-003.000-012	MOON ISLAND LLC	5.40
10	45-20-35-300-001.000-012	MOON ISLAND LLC	305.23
11	45-20-35-100-002.000-012	REICHERT, KEVIN L	74.88
12	45-24-02-100-001.000-012	POSTMA FARMS INC	272.44

Legend

- Interstate
- State Highway
- Rail
- Site Boundary
- Site Parcel
- Parcel

SITE PARCEL CONFIGURATION

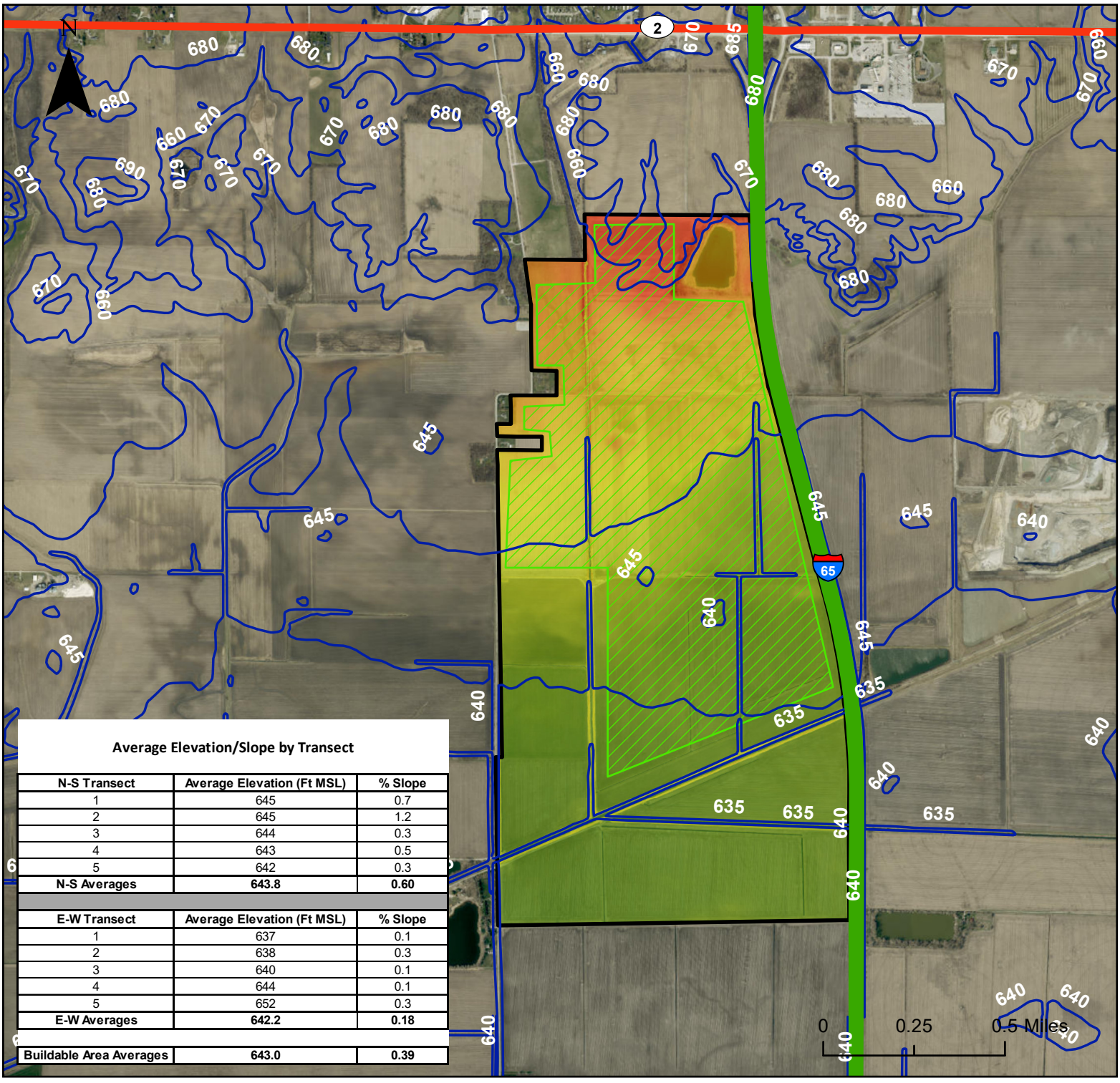
SSI Phase II sponsored by: NIPSCO Energy Efficiency

SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Lake County, Indiana

Site ID: 18089-005 (1,019.3 acres)



Average Elevation/Slope by Transect

N-S Transect	Average Elevation (Ft MSL)	% Slope
1	645	0.7
2	645	1.2
3	644	0.3
4	643	0.5
5	642	0.3
N-S Averages	**643.8**	**0.60**

E-W Transect	Average Elevation (Ft MSL)	% Slope
1	637	0.1
2	638	0.3
3	640	0.1
4	644	0.1
5	652	0.3
E-W Averages	**642.2**	**0.18**

Buildable Area Averages	**643.0**	**0.39**

Legend

- Interstate
- State Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Contours - 10 ft
- **LiDAR-derived DEM**
  - High : 741'
  - Low : 708'

BUILDABLE AREA ELEVATION/SLOPE

LiDAR-derived Digital Elevation Model

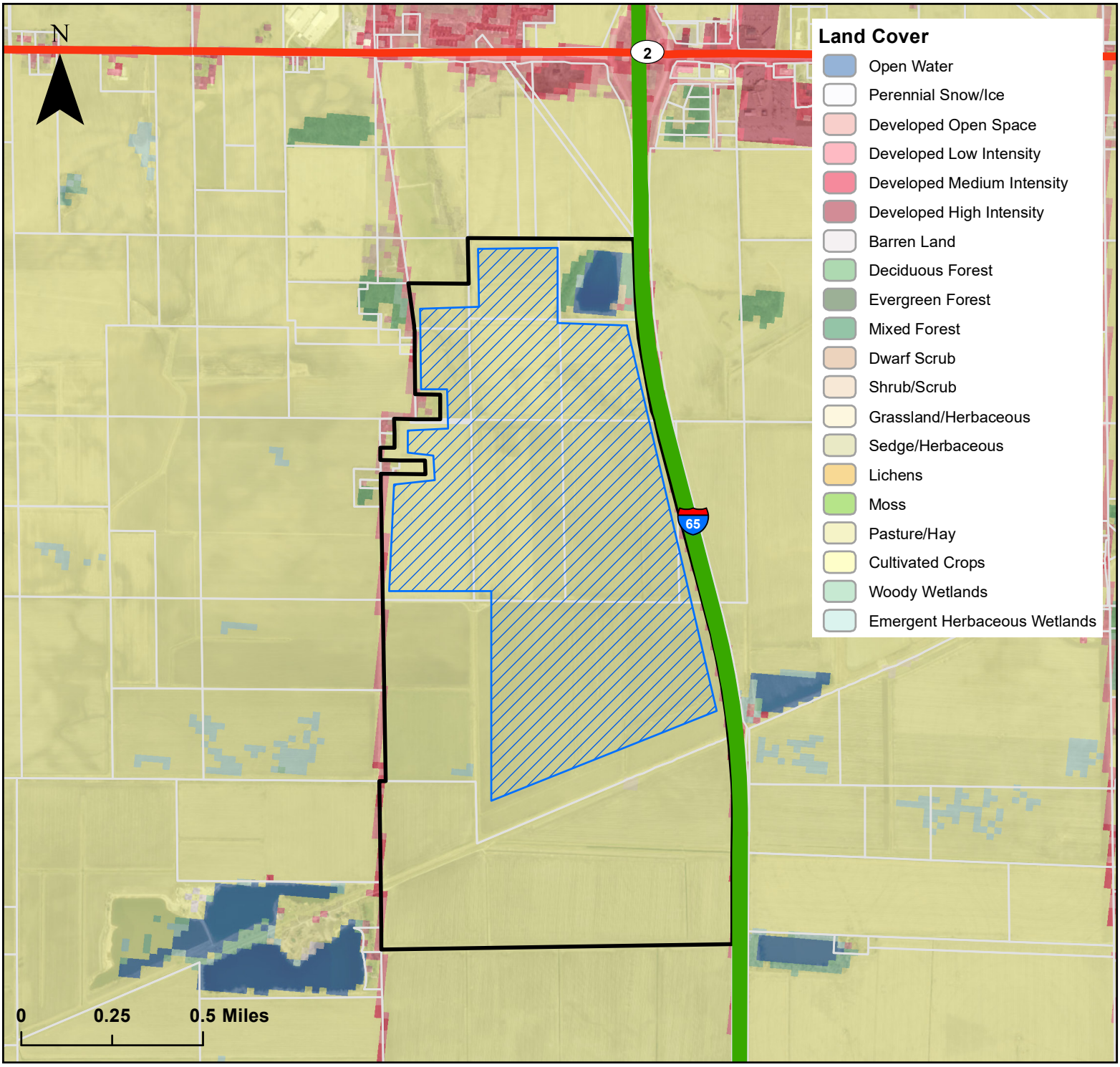
SSI Phase II sponsored by: NIPSCO Energy Efficiency

SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Lake County, Indiana

Site ID: 18089-005 (1,019.3 acres)



Legend

- Interstate
- State Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Parcel

LAND COVER CLASSIFICATIONS

Indiana 2017-2021 Land Cover Map

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SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Lake County, Indiana

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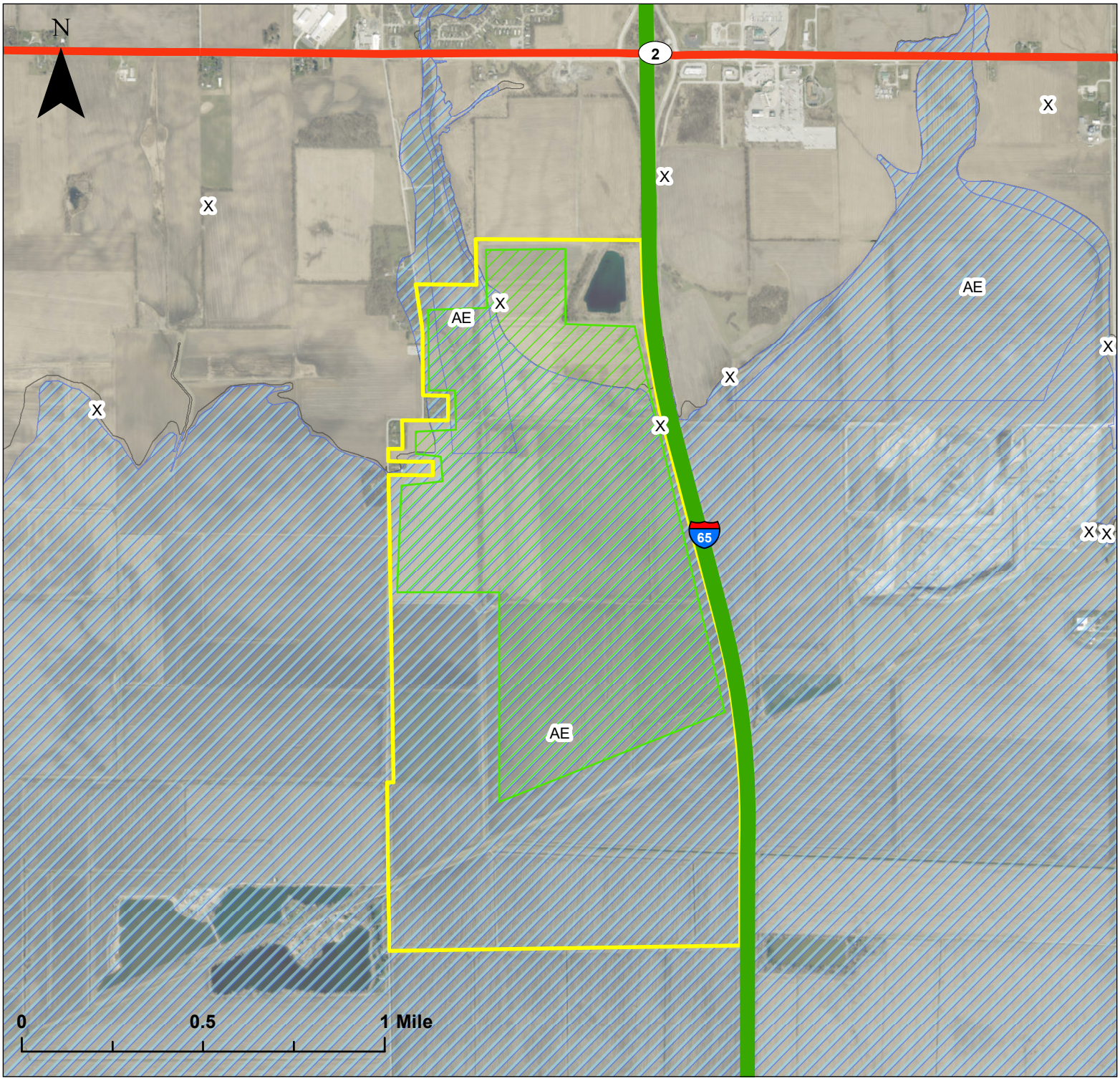

Legend

- Interstate
- State Highway
- Rail
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

Flood Zone

- AE
- X

Potential Flood Hazard

FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer

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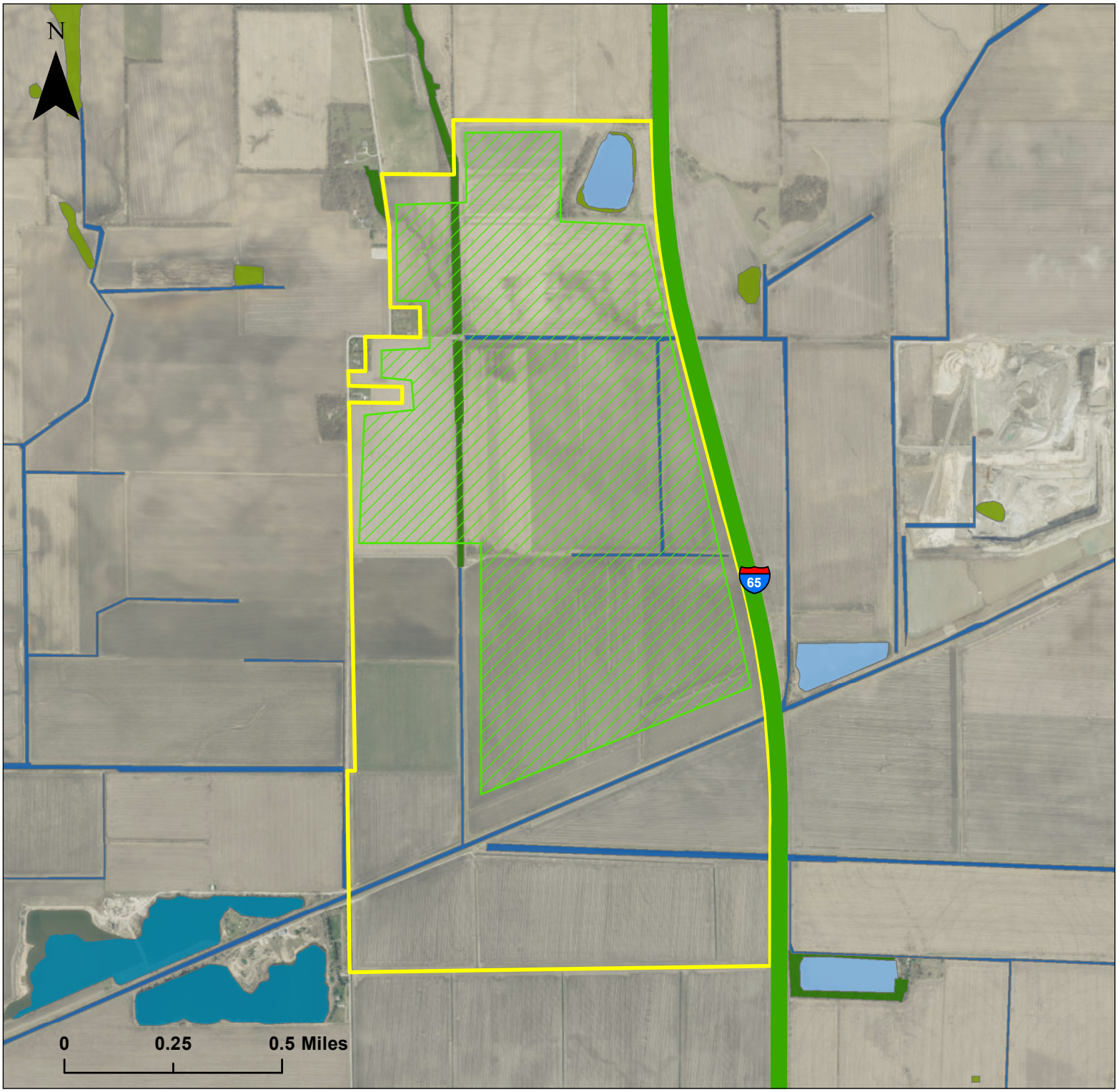

Legend

- Interstate
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

National Wetlands Inventory

Potential Wetland Type

- Freshwater Emergent Wetland
- Freshwater Forested/Shrub Wetland
- Freshwater Pond
- Lake
- Riverine

Potential Wetlands

USFW/USGS National Wetlands Inventory

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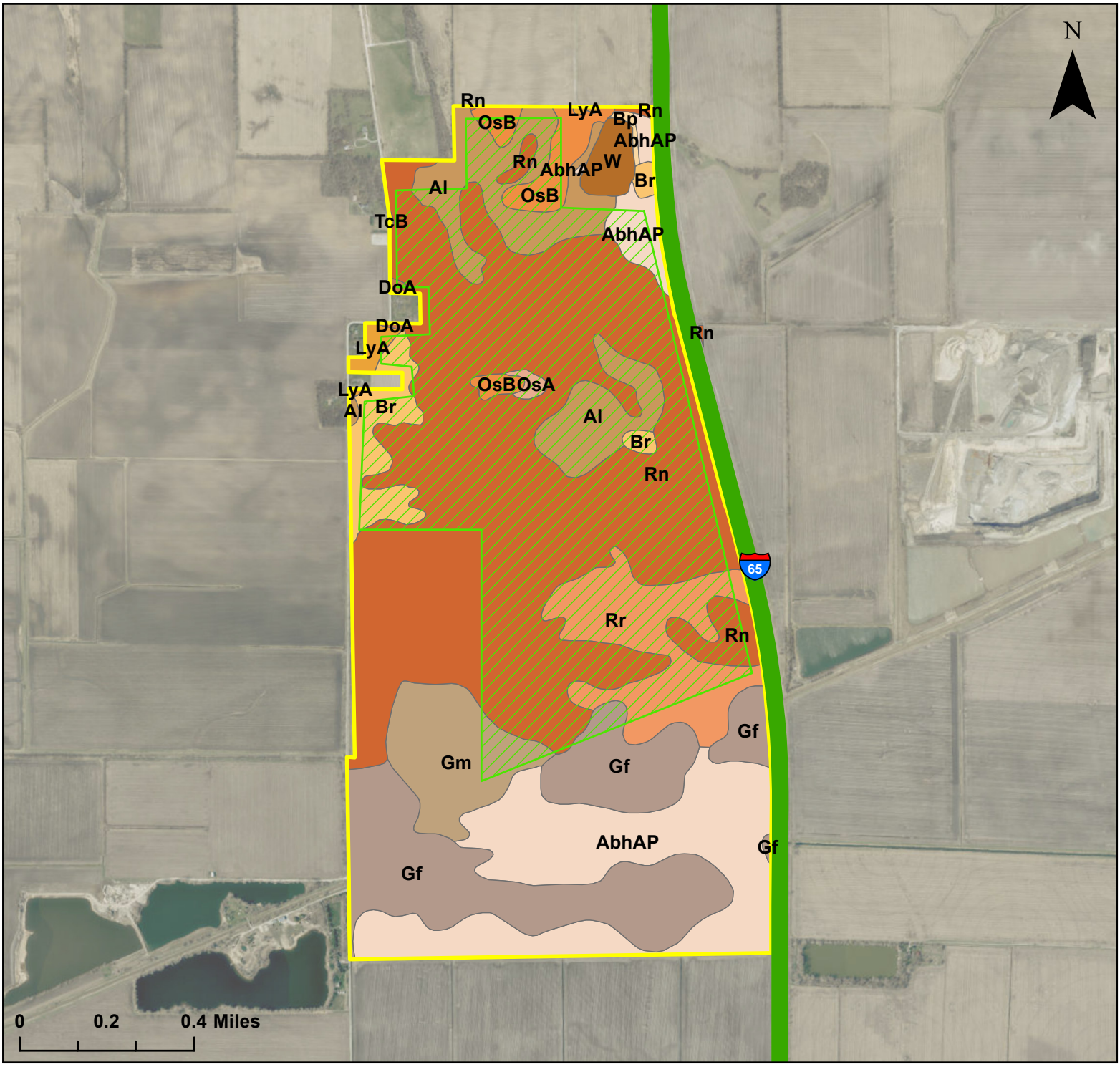

Legend

- Interstate
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

Soil Types

- AbhAP
- Al
- Bp
- Br
- DoA
- Gf
- Gm
- LyA
- OsA
- OsB
- Rn
- Rr
- TcB
- W

SSURGO SOILS

Map Unit Name, Percent Slopes

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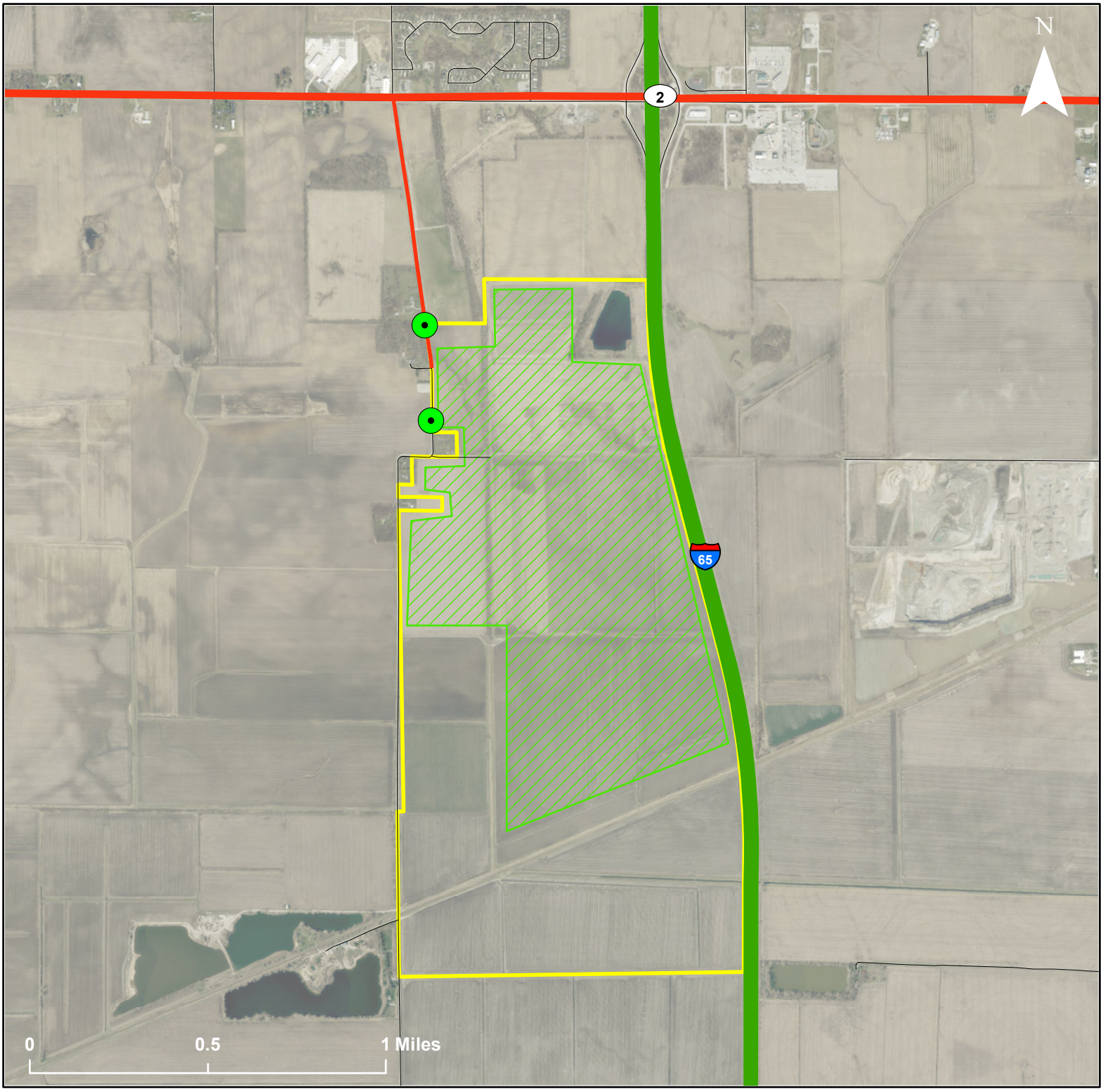

Legend

- Potential Egress/Ingress Point
- State Highway
- Interstate
- MississippiStreet
- Street
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

SITE TRANSPORTATION FEATURES

with Potential Site Access Points

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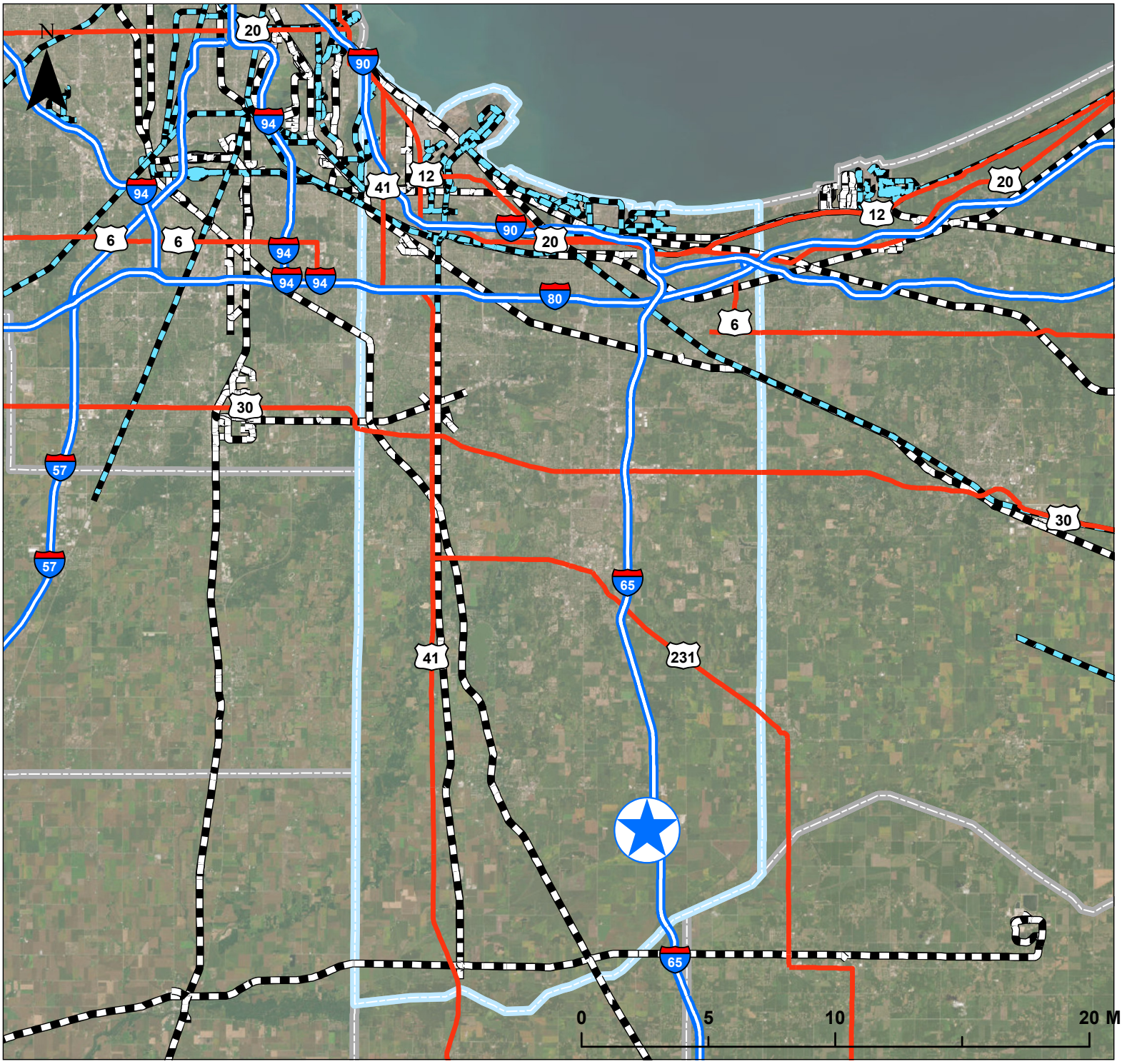
SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Lake County, Indiana

Site ID: 18089-005 (1,019.3 acres)



Legend

- Class I Railroad
- Shortline
- Interstate
- U.S. Highway

SITE PRIMARY TRANSPORTATION ASSETS

- Site Point
- Lake County
- County

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Lake County, Indiana

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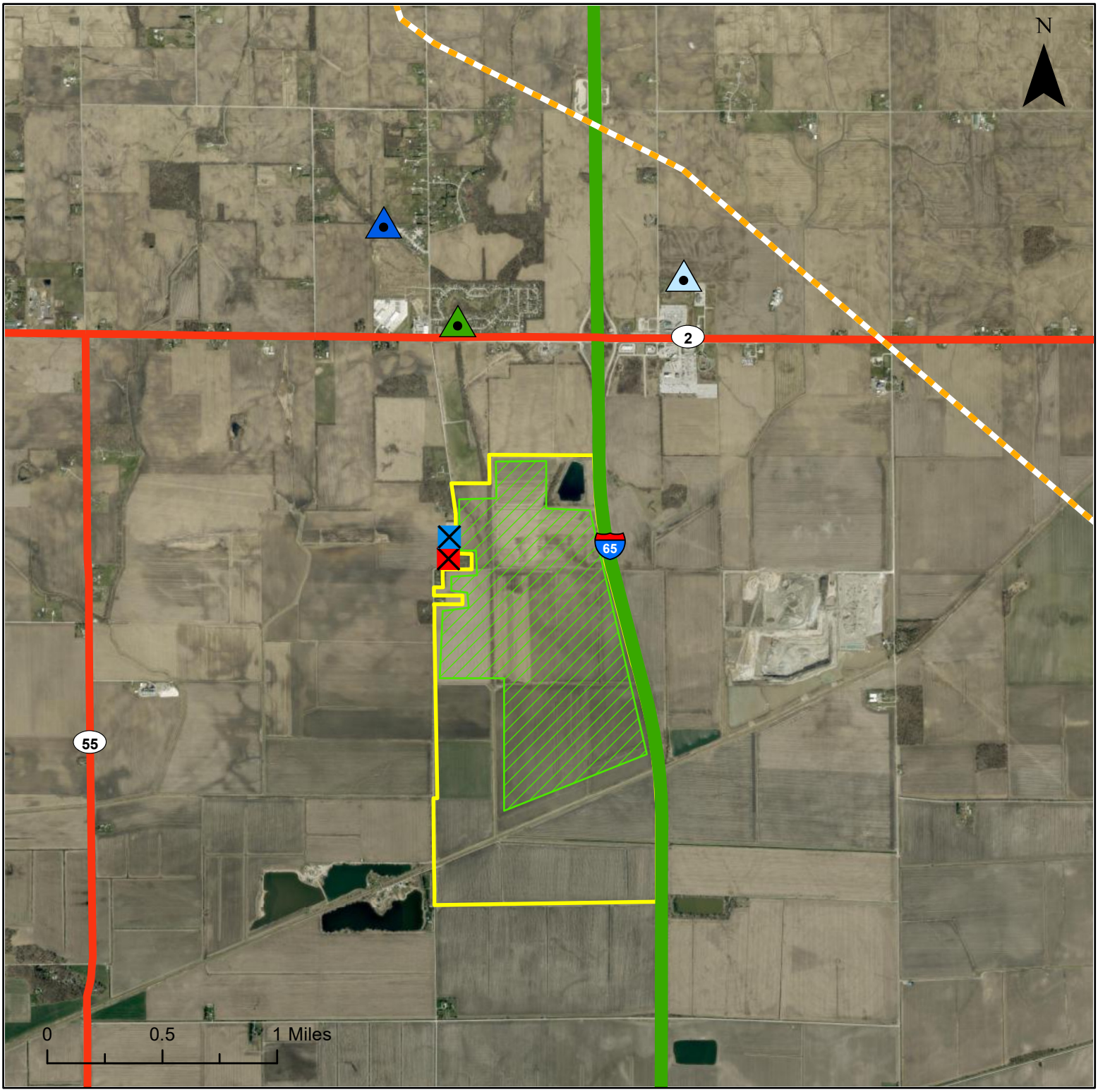

Legend

Water & Sewer

- Proposed Water Plant
- Existing Water Supply
- Existing WWTP

Utility Type

- Electric, Gas
- Water, Sewer
- Electric Substation
- Electric Transmission Line
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Municipal Limits

ENERGY INFRASTRUCTURE/UTILITY ACCESS

with Utility Access Point

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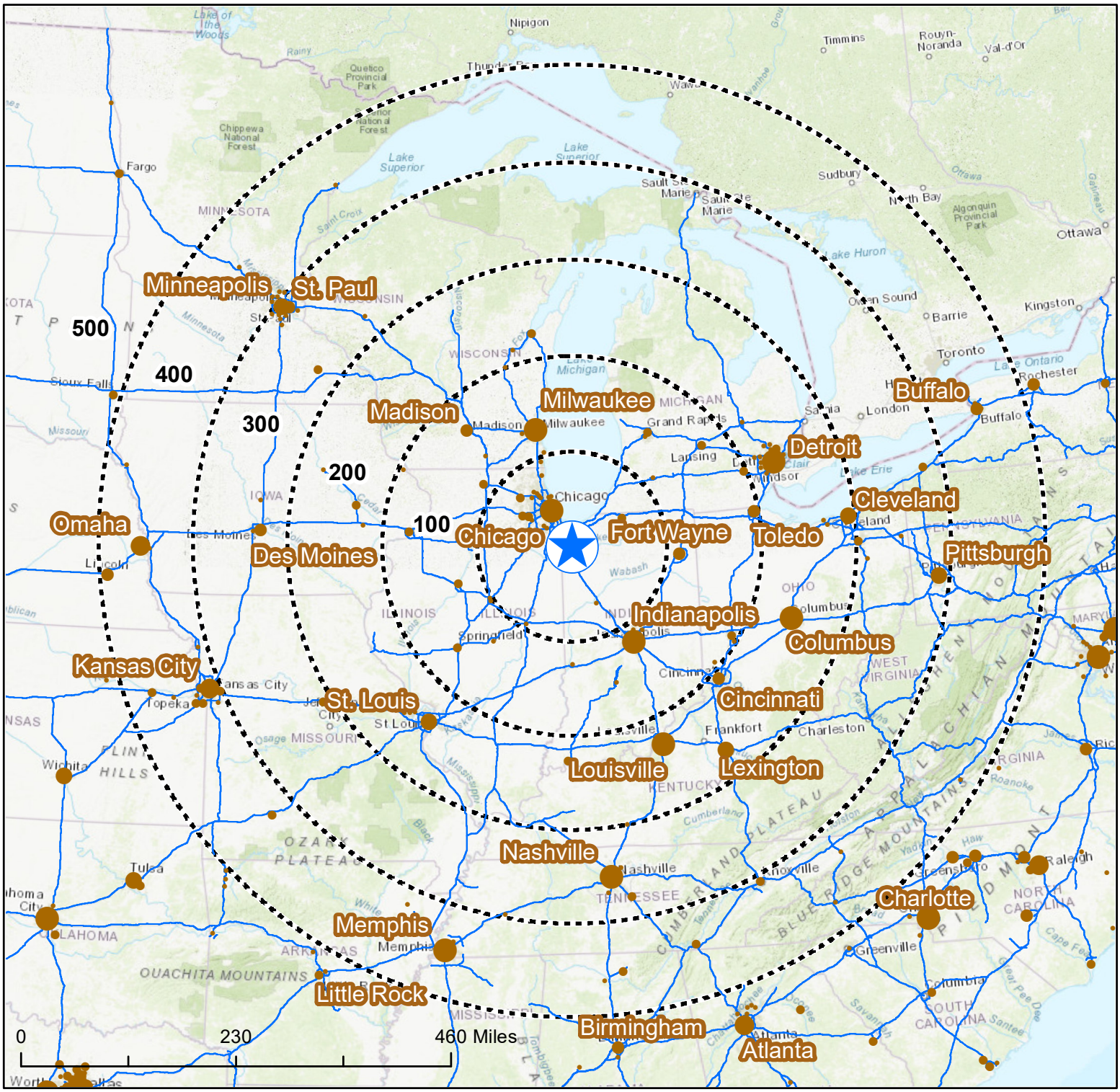

Legend

- Site Point
- Interstate
- Distance in Miles

Major Markets

Population

- <100,000
- 100,000 - 199,999
- 200,000 - 299,999
- 300,000 - 399,999
- 400,000 - 499,999
- >500,000

TRAVEL DISTANCE

Major Markets

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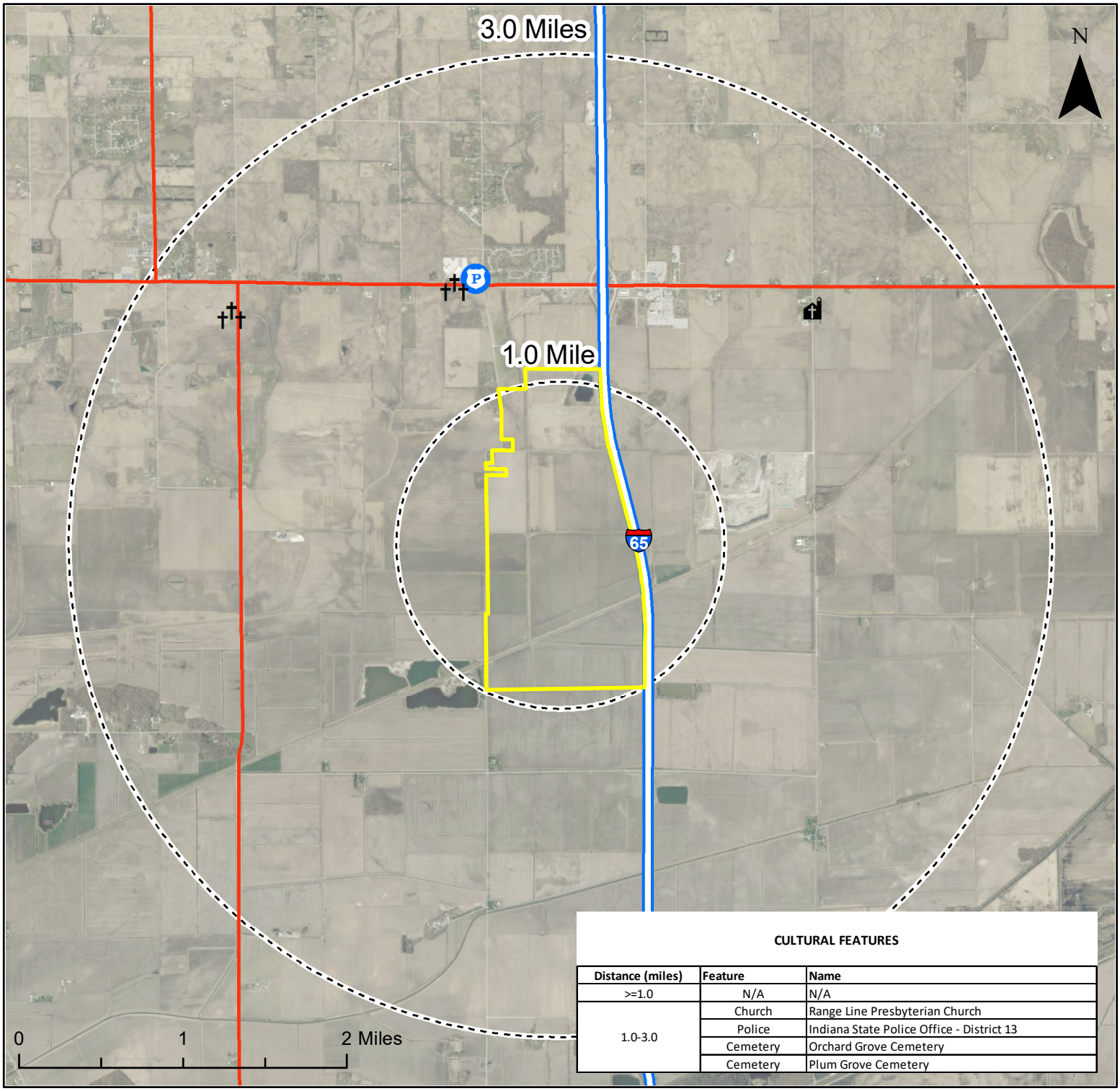

CULTURAL FEATURES

Distance (miles)	Feature	Name
>=1.0	N/A	N/A
1.0-3.0	Church	Range Line Presbyterian Church
	Police	Indiana State Police Office - District 13
	Cemetery	Orchard Grove Cemetery
	Cemetery	Plum Grove Cemetery

Legend

- Limited Access
- Highway
- Site Boundary
- Distance in miles
- Municipal Limits
- Police Station
- Fire Rescue/EMS
- Hospital
- School
- Cemetery
- Church

CULTURAL FEATURES

within 1.0 and 3.0 Miles of Site

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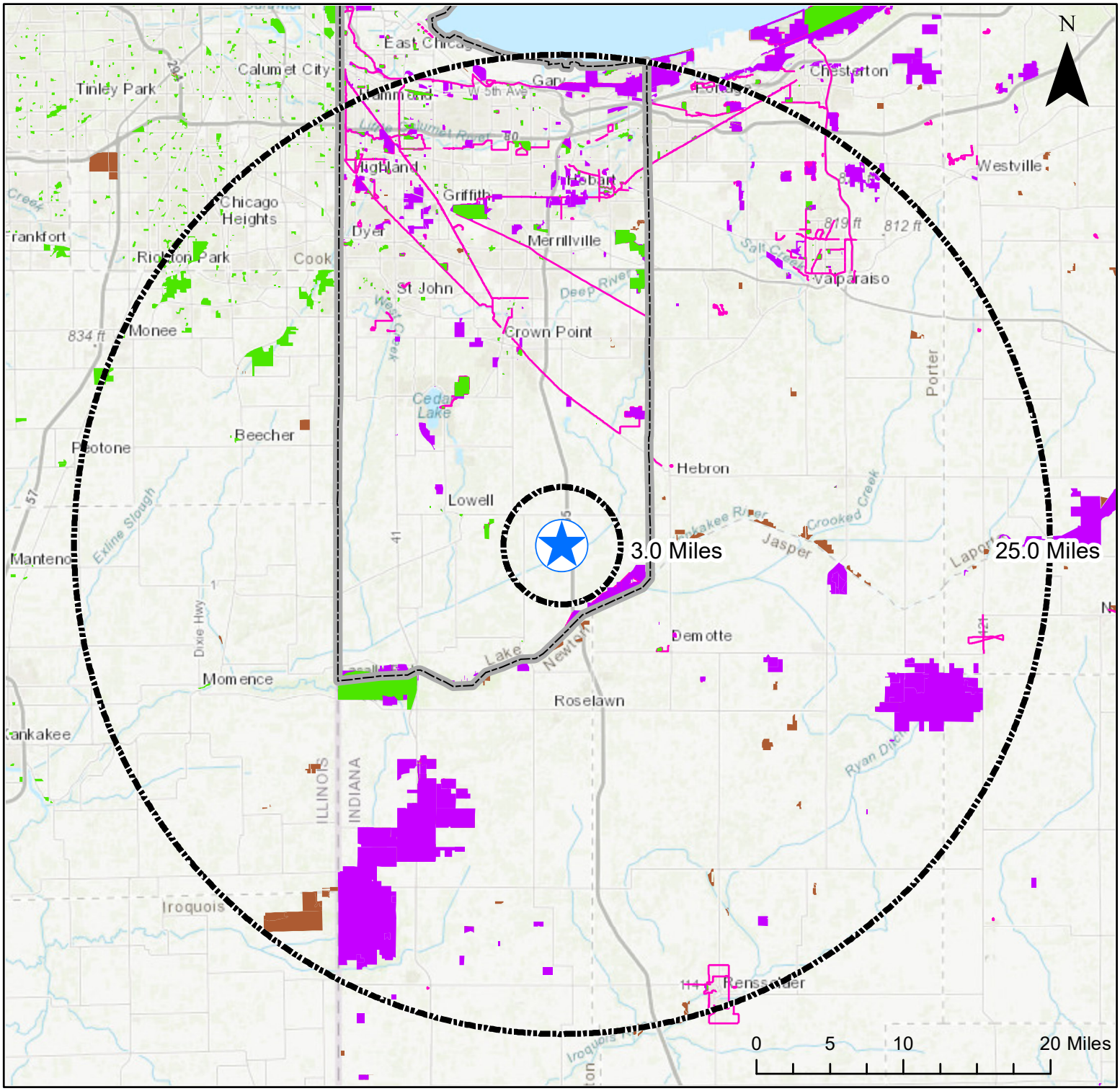

Legend

- Site Point
- IDNR Trails
- Lake County
- Local/State Parks
- National Forests
- INDR Managed Lands
- Conservation Easements
- Distance in Miles

FEDERAL, STATE, AND LOCAL PARKS AND PROTECTED AREAS

within 3.0 and 25.0 Miles of Site

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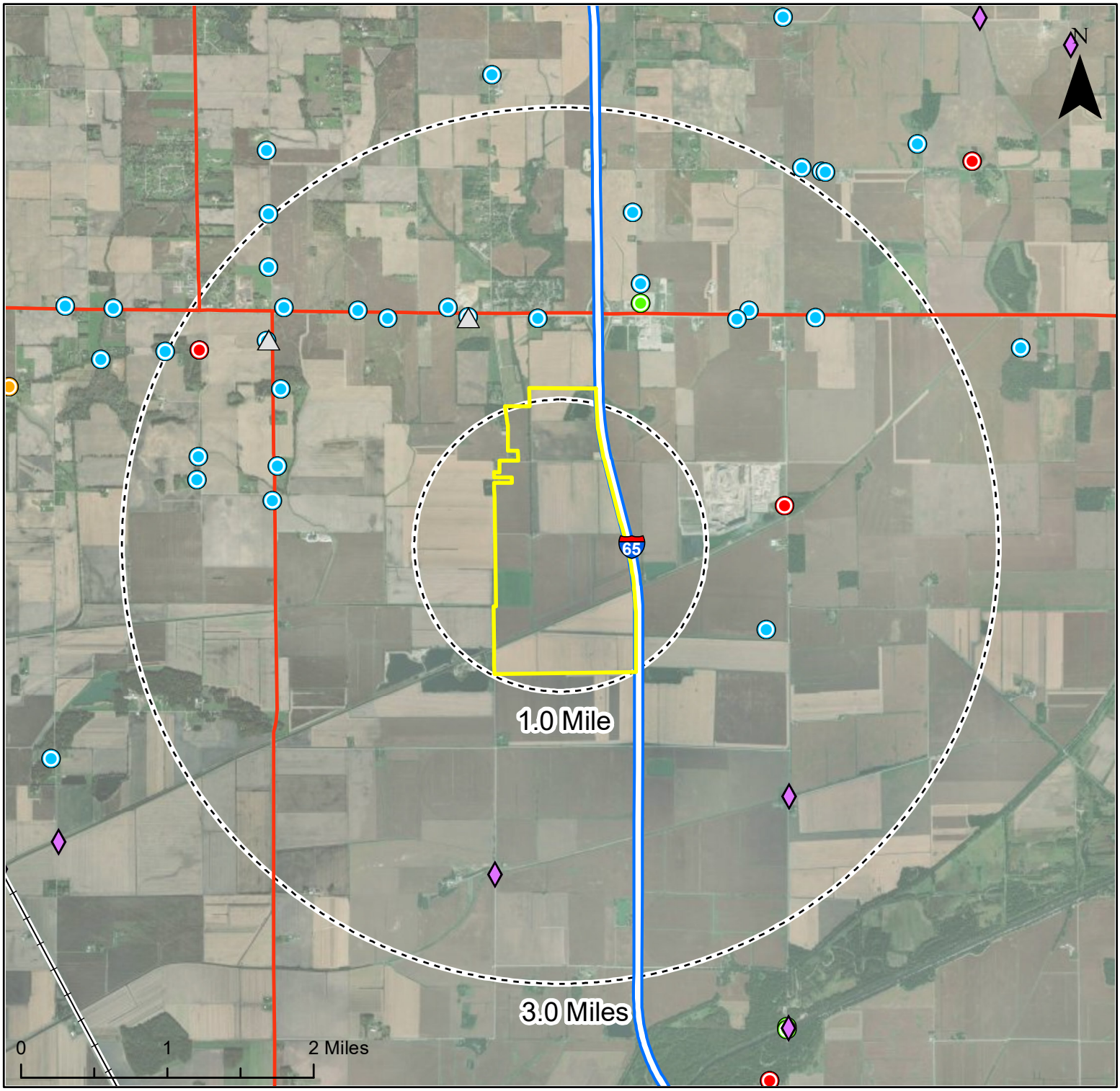

Historic Sites and Structures

- Demolished
- Non-Contributing
- Contributing
- Notable
- Outstanding

- Historic Bridge
- Cemetery
- Limited Access
- Rail
- Highway
- Site Boundary

Distance in miles

HISTORIC RESOURCES

within 1.0 and 3.0 Miles of Site

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